

Later Wittgenstein — Complete Offline Revision Guide

Philosophy Optional · Paper I · Western Philosophy · Topic 08

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Page numbers are generated from the final layout. PDF bookmarks include finer subheadings.

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Syllabus boundary: Meaning and use; language-games; critique of private language.

Source discipline: The latest learner-v2 g5 session and workbook are checked against the canonical owner. Source-cell retention is checked mechanically through anchored headings, term witnesses and the coverage ledger; this does not prove semantic completeness. Repeated source apparatus is consolidated for offline revision. Markdown is canonical.

Current-affairs boundary: No direct verified current-affairs event is established for this conceptual topic. Contemporary relevance to pragmatics, philosophy of mind and artificial intelligence is analytical context, not a fabricated dated event.

PYQ update: The seven directly owned questions from 2018–2025 are joined by 2026 Q3(c). Topic 08 therefore owns eight verified parts through repository year 2026. Early Wittgenstein and Logical Positivism questions remain cross-links to Topics 06 and 07, not duplicate ownership.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

Concept map: the transition from picturing to diverse language practices connects use, grammar and forms of life to rule-following, private language and philosophical therapy without reducing meaning to behaviour.

Syllabus (verbatim): Later Wittgenstein : Meaning and Use; Language-games; Critique of Private Language.

How to Use This Five-Layer Session

Every logical subtopic follows exactly:

Layer	Purpose
1. SIMPLE START	visual-first plain-language gateway
2. CORE UPSC	complete terminology, doctrine, argument, example and PI-section grounding
3. ADVANCED	objections, replies, comparisons, interpretive issues and provenance cautions
4. EXAM APPLICATION	verified PYQ routes and 10/15/20-mark architecture
5. RAPID REVISION	traps, retrieval notes and links to the exact MCQ set

Source Audit and Contemporary-Link Boundary

- **Canonical doctrine source:** upsc-ai-kit/knowledge/Philosophy/paper-1/western/Later-Wittgenstein.md (reviewed owner; live word count not frozen here), used across the CORE UPSC layers and checked against the consolidated canonical apparatus. - **Verified PYQs:** continuous local

Western Philosophy Paper I bank, 2018-2025; this clause owns **7** primary parts in 2018–2025, one each in 2018, 2019, 2020, 2022, 2023, 2024 and 2025. **2021 is the only year without an owned part.**

- **Ownership discipline:** early-Wittgenstein (*Tractatus*) parts and Logical Positivism parts are owned by their own clauses and appear here only as labelled comparisons; none is counted among the 7. - **Printed anomalies retained exactly:** the 2022 Q1(c) official English line prints "**motion** of language" (a slip for "notion"), and the 2025 Q3(a) statement retains an **unmatched opening quotation** before "logical structure". Both are reproduced exactly and explained, never silently corrected. - **Provenance discipline:** the *Philosophical Investigations* was published **posthumously in 1953** (Wittgenstein died 1951), edited by G. E. M. Anscombe and Rush Rhees, Anscombe translating; the *Tractatus* is 1921/1922. The duck-rabbit belongs to **PI Part II xi / PPF** and to Jastrow; "Kripkenstein" is a labelled reading, not Wittgenstein's own doctrine. - **OCR-searchable local PDFs:** *Think. A Compelling Introduction To Philosophy.pdf* and *Robert.Audi.The.Cambridge.Dictionary.of.Philosophy.pdf* were searched for Wittgenstein, rule-following, language-games and private language; *HistoryPhilosophy1.pdf* was also audited for searchable coverage. These sources corroborate the Markdown owners but do not replace them.
- **Qdrant:** optional fallback only; not required for this canonical topic. - **Contemporary link (deliberately not forced):** a live search across 2026-02-19 to 2026-08-19 produced no sufficiently direct, well-verified official or academic development to anchor this clause, and no AI/LLM blog item is promoted to a current-affairs anchor. The honest contemporary relevance is static and disciplinary: meaning-as-use, criteria and forms of life underwrite present-day **philosophy of language and mind** (pragmatics, use-based and inferential semantics, the philosophy of psychology), which is why the clause is examined almost every year. That is stated as analysis, not as a dated news event.

Preservation note: the canonical doctrine is reorganised into layers. The validator checks the explicit source-cell inventory and named witnesses; interpretive adequacy and completeness still require human review.

Learning Roadmap

Unit	Logical subtopic
1	The Break from the <i>Tractatus</i> - Placement, the One-Screen Map and Why the Later Philosophy Begins
2	Meaning as Use - the Toolbox, the PI 43 Qualification and Mastery of a Technique
3	Family Resemblance - Overlapping Similarities, Fuzzy Boundaries and 'Don't Think, But Look'
4	Language-Games - Language Woven into Activity, the Builders and Rules by Training
5	Forms of Life - PI 19, Agreement in Form of Life, the Lion Remark and the Bedrock of Justification
6	Rule-Following and the Paradox (PI 201) - Interpretation Regress, Practice and Going On
7	The Private-Language Argument - Logical Privacy, the Diary 'S', the Beetle and Public Criteria

	Unit	Logical subtopic
	8	Criteria vs Symptoms, PI 580 Outward Criteria and the Behaviourism Charge Answered
	9	Philosophy as Therapy - Language on Holiday, the Fly-Bottle, Perspicuous Representation and 'Leaves Everything as It Is'
	10	Aspect-Seeing and the Duck-Rabbit - Seeing-As, the Dawning of an Aspect and Aspect-Blindness

SESSION 1 — From the Tractatus to the Investigations: Continuity, Break and Method

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The later Wittgenstein changes how philosophy investigates language: instead of seeking one hidden logical essence, he describes the many practices in which words work.

Technical definition: The early Tractatus treats propositions as pictures of possible facts through shared logical form and asks philosophy to delimit sense. Philosophical Investigations, published posthumously in 1953, rejects the demand that every proposition or word have one underlying essence. Language is approached through remarks, examples and reminders rather than a systematic rival theory. Continuity remains in the concern with philosophical confusion and limits; discontinuity lies in the move from ideal logical analysis to the description of ordinary practices and grammar.

VISUAL — Early to later shift: continuity and discontinuity

EARLY: one logical form -> proposition pictures fact -> ideal analysis

|

| continuity: clarify limits and dissolve confusion

v

LATER: many practices -> grammar of use -> description and therapy

DISCONTINUITY: hidden essence / calculus is replaced by survey of actual uses

The same concern with confusion survives, but the diagnosis and method change.

VISUAL — Two methods, not two slogans

TRACTATUS: analyse proposition -> expose logical form -> delimit what can be said

INVESTIGATIONS: compare cases -> give reminders -> see connections -> confusion eases

NOT: picture theory is simply replaced by one universal 'use theory'

YES: a family of grammatical investigations answers different philosophical knots

The later method refuses to turn use into a new reductive essence of meaning.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Later Wittgenstein preserves the early aim of releasing us from philosophical confusion while abandoning the Tractarian assumption that one logical form explains every meaningful use.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **picture theory**
- **logical form**
- **Philosophical Investigations**
- **description**
- **continuity**
- **methodological discontinuity**

How to use them: Open with picture theory and logical form, identify continuity, then explain methodological discontinuity through Philosophical Investigations, description and the rejection of one essence.

CORE OBJECTION, REPLY AND RESIDUAL LIMIT

Objection: Without a positive theory, the later remarks may look fragmentary, conservative or unable to explain why linguistic practices have the authority they do.

Best reply: The anti-systematic form is deliberate: the target is the craving for a single explanation, and the success test is removal of a specific confusion rather than construction of a system.

Residual limit: Description can still conceal commitments about practice, normativity and human agreement; the therapeutic reading therefore remains contestable.

EXAM USE AND CONCISE REVISION

Answer architecture: Use a continuity/discontinuity matrix, then connect the transition to use, language-games, rules, private language and therapy before giving a qualified verdict.

- Early: proposition pictures a possible fact through logical form.
- Later: look at diverse uses instead of positing one hidden essence.

- Continuity concerns clarification and limits; discontinuity concerns method and language.
- The Investigations is posthumous (1953); avoid saying Wittgenstein published it.

Visual gateway - one thinker, two philosophies

THE SAME MAN, TWO PICTURES OF MEANING	
EARLY (Tractatus, 1921)	LATER (Investigations, 1953)
Meaning = PICTURING facts	For many cases: meaning clarified by USE
ONE hidden essence (logical form)	NO single required essence - FAMILY RESEMBLANCE
Name -> Object (fixed reference)	Countless LANGUAGE-GAMES
Build an IDEAL logical language	Ordinary language is in order
Private inner reference is fine	PRIVATE LANGUAGE is impossible
Philosophy = draw limits; be silent about the rest	Philosophy = THERAPY: dissolve knots made by language idling

Caption: read the two columns as a before/after. Everything in this syllabus item is the right-hand column reacting against the left.

Plain-language start: The young Wittgenstein thought a sentence is meaningful because it is a *picture* of a possible fact - words hook onto objects, and the sentence models reality the way a scale-model models a car crash. That is the *Tractatus*. Decades later he decided this was a beautiful mistake. Real language is not one machine that pictures; it is a huge kit of different tools used in different activities - ordering, joking, praying, measuring, greeting. So meaning is not "what a word pictures" but "what people *do* with the word." The later philosophy is the working-out of that one change, and the exam rewards you for tracing it precisely.

Idea	Plain meaning
Picture theory	a sentence means by mirroring a possible fact
Use theory	a word means by its role in a shared activity
Augustinian picture	the tempting idea that every word names an object
Colour-exclusion problem	"this spot is red" and "this spot is green" cannot both be true, yet the Tractatus said elementary propositions are independent - a crack Wittgenstein himself found in 1929
Description, not theory	philosophy should describe how language works, not build a rival theory of meaning

 **Mnemonic - "PEIPS -> UFLOT":** the early Picture / Essence / Ideal-language / Private-reference / Silence flips into later Use / Family-resemblance / Language-games / Ordinary-language / Therapy.

Placement: The *second* Wittgenstein (*Philosophical Investigations*, 1953) revises the earlier *Tractatus*. Meaning is no longer exhausted by picturing; it is **use in a form of life**. This owner carries 7 parts in 2018–2025, with no primary-owned part in 2021; family resemblance and private language are the restored-year additions.

0. ONE-SCREEN MAP ⚠️

EARLY (Tractatus, 1921)	LATER (Investigations, 1953)
Meaning = PICTURING facts in practice	For many cases: meaning clarified by USE
One essence of language (logical form)	NO single essence – FAMILY RESEMBLANCE
Name → Object (fixed reference)	Countless LANGUAGE-GAMES
Ideal logical language	Ordinary language is perfectly in order
Solipsism lies at language's limit	PRIVATE OSTENSION cannot found a language
Philosophy = draw limits of the sayable; "be silent" about the rest	Philosophy = THERAPY (dissolve knots created by language "on holiday")
Key terms: use · language-game · form of life · family resemblance · rule-following · private language · beetle-in-a-box · therapeutic conception	

🔑 **Mnemonic — "U-G-F":** Meaning is **Use**; uses are organised as language-**G**ames; games are grounded in **F**orms of life.

1. THE BREAK FROM THE *TRACTATUS* — AND WHY (PYQ 2025 Q3(a), 2023 Q4(c))

1.1 What Changed ✅

<i>Tractatus</i> assumption	Later Wittgenstein's rejection	Reason
Language has ONE essence — picturing facts via shared logical form	Language has NO single essence; there are indefinitely many language-games, each with its own "grammar"	"Don't think, but LOOK" — when we actually examine how language is used, we find irreducible diversity
Meaning = the possible state of affairs a proposition pictures	For a large class of cases, meaning is clarified by use	The word "game" does not picture a single thing; its meaning is its varied use across contexts
One general logical form/deep analysis explains factual sense	Ordinary language is <i>perfectly in order as it is</i> — no need for an ideal language behind it	Philosophical problems arise not from deficient language but from <i>misunderstanding</i> the workings of our language

<i>Tractatus</i> assumption	Later Wittgenstein's rejection	Reason
Elementary propositions are logically independent	Colour-exclusion cases make apparently elementary propositions incompatible and pressure the early independence requirement	This was one of the first cracks Wittgenstein himself noticed (1929)
Names get meaning by standing for objects	Names get meaning through their role in language-games — training, context, use	The "Augustinian picture of language" is at best one primitive language-game, not the essence of all meaning

1.2 The Transition Quoted (2025 Q3(a))

⚠ The 2025 question quotes (in substance): *"We should look not to an ideal language which derives its meaning from facts and has a precise logical structure but empirically, to the ways in which languages are actually used."*

This captures the shift: from a **top-down logical theory** of meaning (the *Tractatus*) to a **bottom-up descriptive investigation** of actual linguistic practice (the *Investigations*). The later Wittgenstein does not construct a rival *theory* of meaning — he refuses the very demand for a theory. Philosophy's role is now *description*, not explanation.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW — From the *Tractatus* to the *Investigations*: Continuity, Break and Method

SUBTOPIC: From the *Tractatus* to the *Investigations*: Continuity, Break and Method
 STARTING CONCEPT: From the *Tractatus* to the *Investigations*: Continuity, Break and Method
 KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS: picture theory | logical form | Philosophical Investigations | description | continuity | methodological discontinuity
 MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Tractarian picture/logical-form project -> internal and grammatical pressures -> description of actual uses -> therapeutic remarks rather than system-building.
 CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Language becomes a plurality of human practices, while philosophy remains an activity of clarification rather than an empirical science.
 UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not import meaning-as-use into the *Tractatus*, erase continuity, or say that the later work simply replaces one complete theory of meaning with another.
 ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Later Wittgenstein preserves the early aim of releasing us from philosophical confusion while abandoning the Tractarian assumption that one logical form explains every meaningful use.

SESSION 2 — Meaning and Use: Augustinian Naming, Qualification and Practical Role

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Words do not all function like labels attached to objects; their meanings are learned through the jobs they perform in rule-governed activities.

Technical definition: Investigations section 43 says that for a large class of cases, though not for all, the meaning of a word is its use in the language. The qualification prevents a universal reductive definition. The Augustinian name-object model is one language-game, useful for some nouns but unable to explain logical particles, numerals, questions, commands, avowals or jokes. Use means a norm-governed role in a practice, not usage frequency, speaker intention, reference, dictionary definition or bodily movement.

VISUAL — Augustinian model versus plurality of uses

AUGUSTINIAN MODEL: WORD -> OBJECT -> SENTENCE COMBINES NAMES

| works for some naming and labelling

v

PLURALITY: order | report | joke | pray | calculate | promise | ask | avow

QUESTION: what role does this expression play here?

Naming is one tool among many, not the master pattern of all language.

VISUAL — Meaning is not five nearby notions

USE -> norm-governed role within a language-game

USAGE FREQUENCY -> how often an expression occurs

INTENTION -> what a speaker privately or publicly aims to do

REFERENCE -> what an expression picks out in some uses

DEFINITION -> one teaching or stipulating device; not the whole meaning

The distinctions prevent a slogan from becoming a reductive theory.

VISUAL — Meaning, use, practice and grammar

FORM OF LIFE / SHARED BACKGROUND

| enables

PRACTICE + TRAINING -> GRAMMAR / NORMS -> USE IN A LANGUAGE-GAME

|

v

MEANINGFUL ROLE AND CONTRAST

Use is intelligible through the practice and its grammar, not as isolated motion.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Meaning-as-use redirects analysis from an imagined word-object bond to the norm-governed role a word performs in a practice, without denying reference or defining every meaning identically.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- use
- **Augustinian picture**
- **name-object model**
- **mastery of a technique**
- reference
- **speaker intention**

How to use them: Quote the section 43 qualification, explain the Augustinian picture as one limited game, and distinguish use from frequency, intention, reference and definition.

CORE OBJECTION, REPLY AND RESIDUAL LIMIT

Objection: If meaning is explained by use, the account may seem circular: use is already described as correct or meaningful, and widespread misuse is still use.

Best reply: Grammar, training, contrast and correction supply the normative structure absent from mere frequency; use is not a count of occurrences but an instituted role.

Residual limit: The reply describes how standards operate but may not fully explain the source or authority of normativity, especially in innovation and contested practice.

EXAM USE AND CONCISE REVISION

Answer architecture: Build: qualified thesis -> Augustinian target -> tools/slab/number examples -> distinctions among use, reference and intention -> circularity/normativity objection -> measured reply.

- Quote: 'for a large class of cases - though not for all.'
- The naming model is a language-game, not the essence of language.
- Use is a rule-governed role, not frequency, intention or muscular behaviour.
- Understanding is shown by being able to go on appropriately in varied cases.

Visual gateway - words as tools, not labels

THE TOOLBOX PICTURE OF MEANING

+-----+						
	hammer	saw	ruler	glue	screwdriver ...	
	v	v	v	v	v	
	drive	cut	measure	fix	turn	
+-----+						

a word is a TOOL: ask what JOB it does, not what OBJECT it names

|
"Water!" -> a warning? a request? a label?

the SAME word, different USE, different meaning

Caption: "the" and "if" and "five" have no object to point at - yet they clearly mean something, because they have a use.

Plain-language start: Imagine asking, "what does a hammer *refer to*?" The question is silly - a hammer is for *doing* something. Wittgenstein says most words are like that. To know what "pain" or "and" or "game" means is to know how to *use* it in the flow of life, not to hold up a mental picture. Crucially he does not over-claim: in PI section 43 he says this holds "for a large class of cases - though not for all". That hedge matters in the exam - quoting it shows you have read the text and not a slogan.

Move	What it replaces
For a large class of cases, meaning is clarified by use	meaning = the object a word names
Understanding = mastery of a technique	understanding = a private inner image or "click"
Meaning is context-dependent	meaning is fixed once and for all in isolation

 **Mnemonic - "TUC":** meaning is a **T**echnique you master, shown in **U**se, fixed by **C**ontext.

2. MEANING AND USE ✓

2.1 The Thesis ✓

✓ *"For a large class of cases — though not for all — in which we employ the word 'meaning' it can be defined thus: the meaning of a word is its use in the language."* (Investigations §43)

Key moves:

1. **Rejection of the referential / "Augustinian" picture:** The idea that *every* word works by naming an object (and the sentence by combining names into a picture) is a primitive model. It works for "table" or "chair" but is useless for "the," "if," "five," "pain," "meaning," "perhaps." Words are **tools in a toolbox** — they have diverse functions, not one (reference). ✓
2. **Understanding = mastery of a technique:** To understand a word is not to have a private mental image or "aha" experience. It is to be able to *go on* using it correctly — a practical ability, publicly demonstrable. ✓
3. **Context-dependence:** Meaning is not fixed in isolation; it depends on the language-game in which the word is being used. The word "Water!" means different things shouted in a fire, requested at a table, or noted on a chemistry board. ✓

CLOSING RECALL FLOW — Meaning and Use: Augustinian Naming, Qualification and Practical Role

SUBTOPIC: Meaning and Use: Augustinian Naming, Qualification and Practical Role

STARTING CONCEPT: Meaning and Use: Augustinian Naming, Qualification and Practical Role

KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS: use | Augustinian picture | name-object model | mastery of a technique | reference | speaker intention

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Training and contrasts establish a word's role -> competent speakers apply it across cases -> meaning is displayed in norm-governed use within a practice.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Imperatives, numerals, greetings, pain avowals and logical words become intelligible without being forced into the mould of object-names.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Never write 'every word simply means its use' or treat observable behaviour as the whole meaning.

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Meaning-as-use redirects analysis from an imagined word-object bond to the norm-governed role a word performs in a practice, without denying reference or defining every meaning identically.

SESSION 3 — Ostensive Definition and Family Resemblance: Background before Pointing

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Pointing at something does not by itself tell a learner whether the word names its colour, shape, material, number, direction or function; training supplies the missing background.

Technical definition: An ostensive definition is an attempt to teach or fix a word by pointing to an example. It succeeds only within a prior grammar that determines what kind of continuation counts as correct. A colour sample can guide colour-use only after the learner is trained in comparison and application. A number series likewise needs a learned technique. Family resemblance describes concepts such as game through overlapping and criss-crossing similarities rather than one feature common to every case. Open texture does not abolish standards: practice still distinguishes central, marginal and mistaken applications.

VISUAL — Ostensive definition depends on background

TEACHER POINTS TO RED SQUARE

| could mean: red? square? tile? one? left? sample?

v

TRAINING + QUESTION + CONTRAST + CORRECTION

v

BACKGROUND GRAMMAR FIXES THE RELEVANT CONTINUATION

The point becomes a definition only after grammar selects the relevant dimension.

VISUAL — Family-resemblance network

BOARD GAME ----- strategy ----- CHESS

| play | competition

| |

CARD GAME ----- chance ----- BALL GAME

\ _____ amusement _____ / \ _ skill _ OLYMPIC GAME

NO FEATURE IN EVERY CASE; MANY CONTROLLED OVERLAPS

Standards arise from overlapping routes through the network, not one shared atom.

VISUAL — Number-series learning

2, 4, 6, 8 ... + instruction 'add 2'

| examples underdetermine indefinitely many continuations

v

TRAINING + CORRECTION + ESTABLISHED TECHNIQUE

v

10, 12, 14 ... as the norm-governed continuation

Finite examples do not mechanically contain every future application.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Ostension cannot create meaning from an uninterpreted point, and family resemblance removes the demand for one essence without removing the practical standards governing a concept.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **ostensive definition**
- **background grammar**
- **colour sample**
- **family resemblance**
- **overlapping similarities**
- **open texture**

How to use them: Define ostensive definition and background grammar, use a colour sample and number series, then explain family resemblance, overlapping similarities and open texture.

CORE OBJECTION, REPLY AND RESIDUAL LIMIT

Objection: Family resemblance may look too permissive because any two things resemble each other in some respect, while ostension seems to presuppose the very meaning it is meant to teach.

Best reply: Relevant resemblances are selected by established training, purposes, contrasts and judgments; ostension operates within, and can extend, this inherited practice.

Residual limit: The account identifies the practical background but leaves hard questions about radical conceptual innovation and cross-practice disagreement.

EXAM USE AND CONCISE REVISION

Answer architecture: Structure the answer as ambiguity of pointing -> role of training -> family network -> standards without essence -> permissiveness objection and practice-based reply.

- Pointing needs a prepared learner and a background distinction.
- A sample functions as a rule only within a practice of comparison.
- Family resemblance means overlapping similarities, not universal vagueness.
- Absence of one essence is compatible with standards and correction.

Visual gateway - the family web

```

WHAT DO ALL "GAMES" SHARE? -> no single thread
board   card   ball   Olympic   solitaire   war-
games   games  games  games     (no winner) games
  \      |      |      |           |      /
   \      |      overlapping & criss-crossing /
    +----+----- SIMILARITIES -----+-----+
                (skill? luck? winning? fun? rules?)
each pair shares SOMETHING; NO feature is common to ALL
just like a family: the nose here, the gait there, the
temperament somewhere else - a resemblance, not an essence

```

Caption: concepts can be held together by a web of overlapping likenesses, with no core property running through every case.

Plain-language start: Ask "what do all games have in common?" You will fail - some have winners, some do not; some need skill, some luck; some are solitary, some social. Yet "game" is a perfectly good word. Wittgenstein's picture: the cases are related like members of a family - overlapping and criss-crossing resemblances, not one shared essence. And the method that reveals this is not armchair theorising but "Don't think, but look!" - actually inspect the cases.

Term	Plain meaning
Family resemblance	a network of overlapping similarities, no single common feature
Fuzzy boundary	a concept can lack sharp edges and still work
"Don't think, but look"	inspect actual uses instead of demanding a definition

 **Mnemonic - "NO CORE":** Network Of Criss-crossing Overlapping Resemblances, no Essence.

2.2 Family Resemblance ✓

✓ "Don't think, but look!"

Consider "game" — board-games, ball-games, card-games, the Olympic games, war-games, language-games. Is there one thing they all share? No. There is *"a complicated network of similarities overlapping and criss-crossing: sometimes overall similarities, sometimes similarities of detail."* Like the features running through a family — one member has the nose, another the gait, a third the temperament — no single feature is common to all. ✓

Philosophical consequence: Concepts need not have sharp boundaries. Definitions with necessary and sufficient conditions (the Socratic demand; the *Tractatus*'s demand for a single logical form) are not always possible — and that is *fine*. Language works perfectly well with fuzzy-edged concepts.

2.3 "Don't Think, But Look" — The Method ⚠️

The later Wittgenstein's method is **descriptive, not explanatory:**

- Do not ask "What *must* meaning be?" — look at how words *are* used. - Do not seek the hidden *essence* behind varied uses — describe the *variety*. - When puzzled about a concept (knowledge, time, consciousness), assemble *reminders* of how we actually use the word in various language-games — the puzzlement dissolves.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW — Ostensive Definition and Family Resemblance: Background before Pointing

SUBTOPIC: Ostensive Definition and Family Resemblance: Background before Pointing

STARTING CONCEPT: Ostensive Definition and Family Resemblance: Background before Pointing

KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS: ostensive definition | background grammar | colour sample | family resemblance | overlapping similarities | open texture

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Pointing + prior training/grammar -> selected dimension -> corrected applications; overlapping similarities + practice -> extensible concept without one common essence.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Definitions become instruments within practices rather than magical links between sound and object; concepts can remain usable despite fuzzy boundaries.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not infer from 'no single common essence' that anything counts as a game or that ostensive teaching is impossible.

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Ostension cannot create meaning from an uninterpreted point, and family resemblance removes the demand for one essence without removing the practical standards governing a concept.

SESSION 4 — Language-Games and Grammar: Language Interwoven with Activity

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: A language-game is not merely a list of sentence types; it is language working together with an activity, training, rules, participants and a purpose.

Technical definition: Wittgenstein calls the whole consisting of language and the activities into which it is woven a language-game. Ordering slabs, reporting a result, calculating, promising, asking, storytelling, joking and praying differ in point, criteria and response. Grammar means the norms governing representation and use, not only school syntax. The builders' slab language is a complete primitive game for its task, while ordinary Indian public practices such as a railway enquiry, a courtroom promise, a temple prayer or a market request show how the same words can acquire different roles through circumstances.

VISUAL — Components of a language-game

PARTICIPANTS

- + ACTIVITY / CIRCUMSTANCES
- + TRAINING / EXAMPLES / CORRECTION
- + GRAMMAR / RULES
- + PURPOSE / POINT
- > UTTERANCE -> EXPECTED RESPONSE -> SUCCESS OR FAILURE

Every component contributes to intelligibility and to standards of a correct move.

VISUAL — Slab language as a complete primitive game

BUILDER A sees task -> calls 'SLAB!'

| trained convention

v

BUILDER B brings slab -> action completes the order

MEANING IS IN THIS COORDINATED PRACTICE, NOT IN A HIDDEN DEFINITION

Its completeness is relative to the building activity, not to all human purposes.

VISUAL — One expression across public practices

'TICKET' at railway counter -> request / purchase sequence

'PROMISE' in court -> undertaking with accountability

'PRAYER' in worship -> devotional act, not an empirical report

'FIVE' in calculation -> rule-governed numerical operation

Circumstances and purpose change grammatical role without making language arbitrary.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Language-games make meaning inseparable from organised activity: grammar supplies the norms, training supplies competence, and purpose supplies the contrast among uses.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **language-game**
- **activity**
- **training**
- **rules**
- **purpose**
- **grammar**

How to use them: Define language-game through activity, training, rules and purpose; explain grammar as norms of representation and use the slab case as a worked mechanism.

CORE OBJECTION, REPLY AND RESIDUAL LIMIT

Objection: If each game has its own grammar, communication across games and criticism of a practice may seem impossible; theoretical and scientific language may also exceed ordinary examples.

Best reply: Games overlap, borrow and evolve within wider forms of life; comparison is possible through shared practices and perspicuous representation, while scientific language is itself trained use.

Residual limit: The account is strongest as a method of differentiation and weaker as a general causal or historical explanation of language change.

EXAM USE AND CONCISE REVISION

Answer architecture: Answer: definition -> components -> slab mechanism -> plurality with two worked contrasts -> grammar -> cross-game objection -> overlap and evolution reply.

- Language-game = language plus the activity into which it is woven.
- A list of uses is insufficient unless purpose, rules and responses are explained.
- Grammar is normative organisation of representation, not merely syntax.
- Games overlap and change; they are not sealed cultural islands.

Visual gateway - the language-game ecosystem

```

LANGUAGE = language + the ACTIVITIES it is woven into
+-----+
| ordering | describing | reporting | joking | thanking |
| greeting | praying   | guessing | story  | requesting |
+-----+

      not ONE calculus - COUNTLESS games,
      norm-governed in practice, often without an explicit rulebook
      |
      THE BUILDERS: A calls "Slab!" -> B brings a slab
      a COMPLETE primitive language, not a broken bit of ours
  
```

Caption: language is less like one master-machine and more like a whole marketplace of small, self-contained practices.

Plain-language start: A "language-game" (*Sprachspiel*) is the whole package of *words plus the activity they belong to*. When a builder shouts "Slab!" and his mate brings a slab, that tiny exchange is a complete language - it does its job, and it shows that naming/picturing is not the sole linguistic function; trained practical role is decisive. And you learn such games the way you learn any craft: by *training* - being drilled, shown examples, corrected - not by decoding a hidden calculus.

Term	Plain meaning
Language-game (<i>Sprachspiel</i>)	language + the activity into which it is woven
The builders' example	"Slab!" - a complete, self-contained primitive language
Rules by training	rules learned by drill, example and correction, not by grasping an essence
Living language	new games are born, old ones die; language evolves

 **Mnemonic - "WEAVE":** Words Embedded in Activity; games are learned, Varied and Evolving.

3. LANGUAGE-GAMES

3.1 Definition

A **language-game** (*Sprachspiel*) = the whole consisting of language **and the activities into which it is woven**. Language is not a single, uniform calculus but **countless different games** — norm-governed in practice, often without an explicit rulebooks:

✓ Giving orders · describing · reporting · speculating · forming hypotheses · presenting results · telling jokes · making up a story · play-acting · singing · guessing riddles · making a request · thanking · cursing · greeting · praying...

3.2 The Builders' Example ✓

Imagine two builders: A shouts "Slab!" and B brings a slab; "Block!" — a block; "Pillar!" — a pillar. This is a **complete** primitive language — fully functional for its purpose. It is not a deficient version of our language; it is a self-contained language-game. The example shows that naming/picturing is not the sole function; meaning depends on trained practical role. ✓

3.3 Rules and Training ✓

Language-games are **rule-governed** — but rules are learned by *training* (drill, example, correction), not by grasping a Platonic essence or decoding a hidden calculus. New games arise and old ones die; language is *living* and *evolving*.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW — Language-Games and Grammar: Language Interwoven with Activity

SUBTOPIC: Language-Games and Grammar: Language Interwoven with Activity

STARTING CONCEPT: Language-Games and Grammar: Language Interwoven with Activity

KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS: language-game | activity | training | rules | purpose | grammar

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Participants + activity + training + grammar + purpose -> possible moves and responses -> an intelligible language-game with standards of success and failure.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Linguistic diversity becomes principled rather than chaotic, and philosophical errors can be traced to moving an expression from one game into another without its rules.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not reduce language-games to a catalogue, literal competitive games, or cultures sealed off from comparison.

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Language-games make meaning inseparable from organised activity: grammar supplies the norms, training supplies competence, and purpose supplies the contrast among uses.

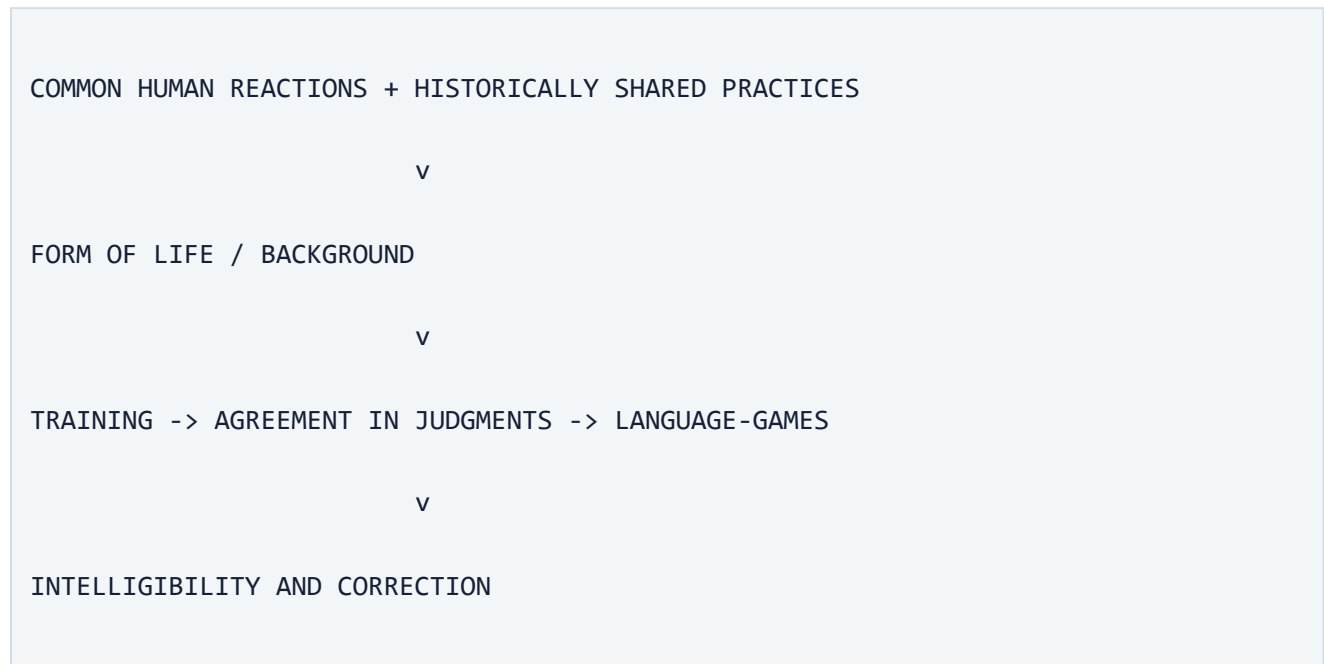
SESSION 5 — Forms of Life, Agreement and Bedrock: Shared Background without Relativism

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Language works because speakers already share ways of acting, reacting, learning and judging; this background is deeper than agreement on a particular opinion.

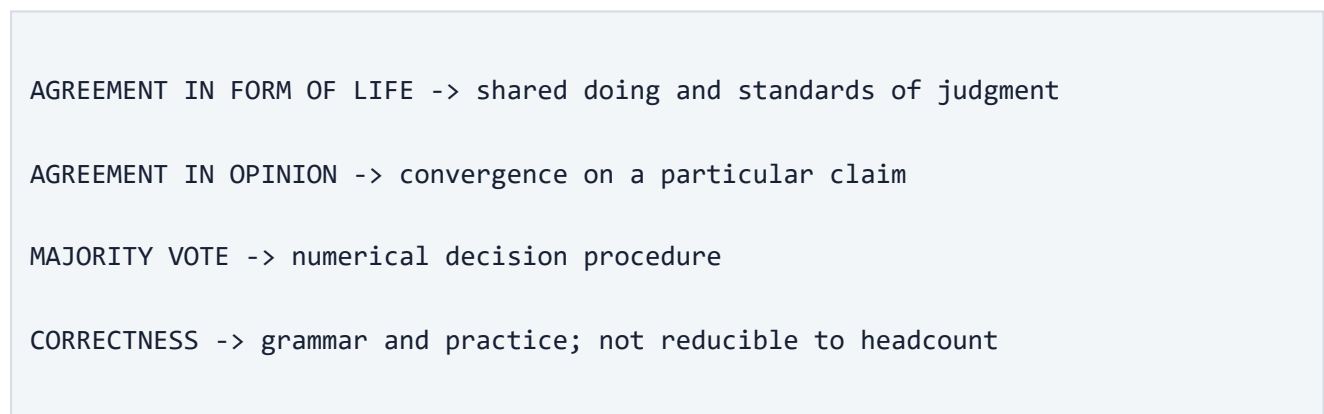
Technical definition: A form of life is the shared human background of practices and natural reactions that makes language-games intelligible. It is not a slogan for biological determinism, a complete cultural worldview or sealed relativism. Agreement in language includes agreement in judgments and forms of life, but not a sociological majority vote. When justification reaches bedrock, 'this is simply what I do' records the end of reasons in an established practice; it does not make every action correct. The lion remark marks the depth of possible difference in intelligibility.

VISUAL — From form of life to intelligibility



The background enables games and judgments without acting as a written super-rule.

VISUAL — Agreement is not majority vote



The distinctions block both individualism and crude communitarianism.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Forms of life explain how rule-governed language has a shared background without converting truth

or correctness into whatever a numerical majority happens to accept.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **form of life**
- **agreement in judgments**
- **shared background**
- **bedrock**
- **this is simply what I do**
- **lion remark**

How to use them: Define form of life modestly, distinguish agreement from opinion and majority, explain bedrock, and evaluate the naturalist, cultural and relativist readings.

CORE OBJECTION, REPLY AND RESIDUAL LIMIT

Objection: The notion is sparse and may hide relativism, conservatism or an unexplained appeal to social fact as a source of normativity.

Best reply: Wittgenstein identifies a transcendental-practical condition of intelligibility rather than a voting procedure; forms of life include common human reactions that enable criticism.

Residual limit: Because the concept is deliberately under-theorised, the balance among biology, culture and normativity remains interpretively unsettled.

EXAM USE AND CONCISE REVISION

Answer architecture: Build a layered background diagram, define agreement carefully, use bedrock and lion, then answer relativism with shared human practices while retaining the residual ambiguity.

- A form of life is a background of shared practices and reactions.
- Agreement in judgments is not agreement in every opinion.
- Bedrock ends justification in practice; it does not license arbitrariness.
- Majority behaviour is neither the definition of truth nor a sufficient rule.

Visual gateway - digging down to bedrock

```
WHY DO YOU FOLLOW THIS RULE? keep asking "why?"...  
rule -> because of another rule -> because... ->
```

```
-----  
| spade turns: "This is simply what I do." |  
| BEDROCK = FORM OF LIFE |  
| shared human practices, reactions, activities |  
-----
```

```
agreement in LANGUAGE = agreement in FORM OF LIFE,  
                        NOT agreement in OPINION
```

```
"If a lion could talk, we could not understand him."
```

Caption: justification does not go on forever; it ends in what we shared-ly *do*.

Plain-language start: Under the language-games lies something even more basic: *forms of life* (Lebensform) - the shared human ways of acting, reacting and living that make the games possible. When you ask "why follow the rule this way?" the chain of reasons runs out, and all that is left is "this is simply what I do." That is not a failure of justification; it is where justification *rests*. And note what "agreement" means here: we agree not by holding the same *opinions* but by sharing a *form of life*. Wittgenstein's vivid test: even if a lion spoke, we could not understand him - his natural history is too unlike ours for the words to connect.

Term	Plain meaning
Form of life (Lebensform)	shared human practices, reactions and activities
Agreement in form of life	shared ways of acting, not shared opinions
The lion remark	too different a form of life breaks understanding
Bedrock	"This is simply what I do" - justification ends in practice

🔑 **Mnemonic - "BAR":** Bedrock is practice; Agreement is in form of life not opinion; Reasons run out at "what I do".

3.4 Forms of Life (*Lebensform*) ✅ (PYQ 2022 Q1(c))

✅ "To imagine a language means to imagine a form of life." (Investigations §19)

Language-games rest on shared human **practices, activities, and natural reactions** — what Wittgenstein calls *forms of life*. Agreement in language is not agreement in *opinions* but agreement **in form of life** — shared ways of acting, reacting, judging.

✅ "If a lion could talk, we could not understand him." — because his form of life (his natural history, reactions, activities) would be so different from ours that the words would not connect to anything we share.

At rule-following bedrock, explanations end in trained action—"This is simply what I do" (§217). This neither defines form of life nor makes majority behaviour infallible. ✅

CLOSING RECALL FLOW — Forms of Life, Agreement and Bedrock: Shared Background without Relativism

SUBTOPIC: Forms of Life, Agreement and Bedrock: Shared Background without Relativism

STARTING CONCEPT: Forms of Life, Agreement and Bedrock: Shared Background without Relativism

KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS: form of life | agreement in judgments | shared background | bedrock | this is simply what I do | lion remark

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Shared natural reactions and practices -> training and stable judgments -> intelligible language-games -> reasons eventually terminate in enacted standards.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Meaning can be public and normative without requiring an infinite chain of explicit reasons.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not say forms of life are purely biological, that each culture is conceptually sealed, or that correctness is whatever most people vote for.

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Forms of life explain how rule-governed language has a shared background without converting truth or correctness into whatever a numerical majority happens to accept.

SESSION 6 — Rule-Following and Normativity: Finite Instructions, Practice and Debate

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: A written rule cannot carry every future application inside itself like a rail; competent continuation depends on training and a practice in which mistakes can be corrected.

Technical definition: Rule-following concerns the normativity that distinguishes doing what a rule requires from merely behaving regularly. Section 201 presents a paradox: any finite instruction can be interpreted so that divergent actions appear to accord with it. A further interpretation generates regress. Wittgenstein's response is that there is a way of grasping a rule that is not an interpretation but is exhibited in obeying and violating it in practice. Training, examples and correction sustain normative continuation; 'this is simply what I do' marks bedrock, not private fiat. Kripke's sceptical paradox and community solution are a contested 1982 reading, not Wittgenstein's uncontested doctrine.

VISUAL — Finite rule to normative continuation

FINITE INSTRUCTION + FINITE EXAMPLES

▼

MANY INTERPRETATIONS CAN FIT

▼

TRAINING + CORRECTION + PRACTICE

▼

Practice bridges the underdetermination of examples without adding an infinite rulebook.

VISUAL — Rule-following paradox and response options

PARADOX: every action can be interpreted as according with the rule

|

+-> MORE INTERPRETATION -> regress; no final determination

+-> KRIPKE 1982 -> sceptical paradox + community assertibility

+-> TEXTUAL DISSOLUTION -> practice is not an interpretation

+-> INDIVIDUAL-PRACTICE REPLY -> repeatable standards need not mean majority

The options must be labelled so Kripke's reading is not mistaken for settled exegesis.

VISUAL — Rule versus regularity

REGULARITY: person always turns left -> description of repeated conduct

RULE: 'turn left here' -> can be obeyed, misunderstood, corrected or broken

NORMATIVE MARKER: being right differs from merely seeming or recurring

Observed repetition becomes rule-following only where correction has a role.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Rules guide because trained practices sustain a distinction between correct and incorrect continuation; neither a private interpretation nor bare behavioural regularity can create that norm.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **rule-following**
- **normativity**

- **regularity**
- **interpretation regress**
- **finite instruction**
- **Kripkenstein**

How to use them: Define rule-following and normativity, reconstruct finite instruction and interpretation regress, distinguish regularity, and label the Kripkenstein debate.

CORE OBJECTION, REPLY AND RESIDUAL LIMIT

Objection: Practice may seem to replace reasons with conformity, while a solitary competent person appears able to follow rules without a present community.

Best reply: The decisive issue is not headcount but standards not exhausted by the agent's present seeming; a solitary practice can retain inherited, repeatable and correctable techniques.

Residual limit: Whether practice explains normativity or only redescribes it remains the central residual problem.

EXAM USE AND CONCISE REVISION

Answer architecture: Use a paradox-response-options map and close by distinguishing the textual dissolution from Kripke's sceptical reconstruction.

- A rule is normative; a regularity merely records what happens.
- No interpretation can be the final rule for applying every prior rule.
- Training and correction support a way of going on that is not another interpretation.
- Kripkenstein is fertile but contested; community is not majority fiat.

Visual gateway - the rule-following flow

```

RULE: "add 2"    2, 4, 6, 8, ... 996, 998, 1000, ...
                |
        pupil writes 1000, 1004, 1008 - "I AM adding 2!"
                |
        can you PROVE he is wrong just from the rule + examples?
        every finite list fits MANY rules -> PARADOX (PI 201):
        "no course of action could be determined by a rule,
         because every course of action can be made to accord with it"
                |
        WRONG fix: add another rule to interpret the rule -> REGRESS
        RIGHT view: rule-following is a PRACTICE - a trained way of
                     GOING ON, "exhibited in obeying the rule"
  
```

Caption: the meaning of a rule is not a further hidden rule; it shows itself in what we do.

Plain-language start: "Add 2" seems crystal clear - until a pupil, at 1000, writes 1004, 1008 and insists he is obeying "add 2" (just "add 2 up to 1000, then 4"). Nothing in the finite examples rules this out; every rule can be "interpreted" to fit any continuation. That is the paradox of PI 201. The tempting fix - supply

another rule to say how to read the first - only launches an infinite regress. Wittgenstein's way out: following a rule is not *interpreting* at all; it is a *practice* - a shared, trained, mostly unreflective way of "going on" that shows itself in the doing.

Term	Plain meaning
The paradox (PI 201)	any action can be made to accord with a rule under some interpretation
Interpretation regress	a rule to fix the rule needs a rule... forever
Practice / going on	rule-following is a trained ability, exhibited in obeying
Normative correctness	there is still a right/wrong, grounded in shared practice

🔑 **Mnemonic - "PIP":** Paradox (any action fits) -> Interpretation regress (no escape by more rules) -> Practice (going on, trained).

4. RULE-FOLLOWING AND THE PARADOX (§201) ✓

4.1 The Problem ✓

What is it to *follow a rule*? Every rule can be interpreted in multiple ways. The rule "add 2" seems clear — but someone might interpret it as meaning "add 2 up to 1000, then add 4." No finite set of examples can fix a unique interpretation. So:

✓ *"This was our paradox: no course of action could be determined by a rule, because every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule." (Investigations §201)*

If *any* action can be made to "accord" with the rule under some interpretation, then the rule determines nothing — and "according with a rule" becomes meaningless.

4.2 Resolution ✓

Wittgenstein's response: the paradox shows that **following a rule cannot consist in interpreting it** (adding a further rule to govern the first rule → regress). Rule-following is a **practice** — a shared, trained, unreflective way of going on. It is grounded in our common form of life, not in a mental act of interpretation.

✓ *"There is a way of grasping a rule which is not an interpretation, but which is exhibited in what we call 'obeying the rule' and 'going against it' in actual cases." (Investigations §201)*

4.3 Relevance to Private Language ⚠️

If rule-following requires a shared practice (with public criteria for correct/incorrect application), then a *purely private* rule — one that no one else *could in principle* check — is incoherent. This is the direct bridge to the private-language argument (§5 below). ⚠️

CLOSING RECALL FLOW — Rule-Following and Normativity: Finite Instructions, Practice and Debate

SUBTOPIC: Rule-Following and Normativity: Finite Instructions, Practice and Debate
STARTING CONCEPT: Rule-Following and Normativity: Finite Instructions, Practice and Debate
KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS: rule-following | normativity | regularity | interpretation regress | finite instruction | Kripkenstein
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Finite rule/examples -> multiple compatible interpretations -> regress if another rule is added -> trained practice displays correct continuation and possible correction.
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Normativity is relocated from an occult mental act to a technique embedded in practice, creating the bridge to private language.
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not say the community makes any answer correct, that every regularity is a rule, or that Wittgenstein straightforwardly endorses Kripke's sceptical solution.
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Rules guide because trained practices sustain a distinction between correct and incorrect continuation; neither a private interpretation nor bare behavioural regularity can create that norm.

SESSION 7 — Private Language: Exact Target, Private Ostension and the Diary S

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: A private language is not solitude or secrecy; it consists of signs whose correctness depends entirely on a sensation available in principle only to one speaker.

Technical definition: An essentially private language contains signs intended to refer to sensations knowable in principle only to one speaker, where correct and incorrect reapplication cannot be independently distinguished. A private ostensive definition tries to fix 'S' by inwardly attending to a sensation. The diary argument asks how a later entry is checked against the original sample. A remembered inner table supplies no independent norm: if whatever seems right counts as right, the contrast constitutive of rule-following disappears. The target is not private thoughts, a diary in English, a secret code or first-person authority.

VISUAL — Private-language diagnostic definition

SIGN refers to an immediate sensation

- + sensation knowable in principle only to this speaker
- + no independent correct / incorrect distinction is possible
- = ESSENTIALLY PRIVATE LANGUAGE TARGET

All three conditions are required; remove one and the target changes.

VISUAL — Diary S and correctness failure

DAY 1: attend inwardly -> write 'S' -> retain memory sample

DAY 20: sensation occurs -> compare with remembered 'S'

| only present seeming judges the sample

v

SEEMS RIGHT = COUNTS AS RIGHT -> NO POSSIBLE ERROR -> NO RULE OF REAPPLICATION

The failure is normative, not the empirical claim that memory always malfunctions.

VISUAL — Private, personal, secret and public

PRIVATE THOUGHT -> inner occurrence; not denied

PERSONAL DIARY IN ENGLISH -> public language used privately

SECRET CODE -> publicly checkable rule, contingently concealed

ESSENTIALLY PRIVATE SIGN -> no possible shared criterion of correction

The classification prevents the standard UPSC category mistake.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The diary S fails not because memory is always unreliable but because an exclusively private memory impression cannot by itself constitute a standard that separates correctness from seeming.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **private language**
- **private ostensive definition**
- **diary S**
- **memory sample**
- **criterion of correction**
- **essential privacy**

How to use them: Define private language and private ostensive definition, reconstruct diary S and the memory sample, then show why a criterion of correction and normativity fail.

CORE OBJECTION, REPLY AND RESIDUAL LIMIT

Objection: A reliable memory, a private natural sign or a public word grounded in private reference may appear to restore the correctness distinction.

Best reply: Reliability is itself assessed through stable applications and possible checks; importing a public word or correlation abandons the essentially private grounding under dispute.

Residual limit: Critics can still ask whether an individual temporally extended practice supplies enough independence, so the argument's reach beyond private ostension is disputed.

EXAM USE AND CONCISE REVISION

Answer architecture: Use a definition filter, the diary sequence and the seeming/right collapse; reserve beetle and sensation grammar for the next session rather than treating one illustration as the proof.

- Private means in-principle semantic privacy, not practical secrecy.
- Private ostension cannot determine what counts as the same sensation later.
- The diary attacks a normative standard, not the general reliability of memory.
- Private thoughts and first-person authority remain intact.

Visual gateway - the private diary argument

```
WHAT A PRIVATE LANGUAGE IS (get the definition right!)
NOT: a secret code (that is translatable -> public)
NOT: talking to yourself (English, others could hear)
YES: words for sensations only I can know, that NO ONE
      else could in principle understand = LOGICALLY private
-----
THE DIARY (PI 258): I write "S" each day I feel a sensation
Day 1: "S"    Day 2: "S"?    ... is today's really S?
no independent check of "same" -> "right" has no grip
"whatever is going to seem right to me is right. And
that only means that here we can't talk about 'right'."
-----
THE BEETLE (PI 293): everyone has a box, calls its content
```

"beetle", no one can look in another's box. The word "beetle" has a USE -> the thing in the box "drops out as irrelevant".

Caption: a sign with no possible criterion separating correct from merely seeming-correct use is not functioning as a word.

Plain-language start: First, fix the target - this is the single biggest exam trap. A "private language" does *not* mean a secret code (codes can be cracked and shared) or muttering to yourself (that is ordinary language, just quiet). It means a language whose words refer to *inner sensations that only the speaker could possibly know*, so that *no one else could even in principle* understand it - **logically** private. Wittgenstein argues such a language is impossible. In the diary example (PI 258) you try to name a recurring private sensation "S"; but with nothing outside your impression to check against, "this is the same S again" has no independent standard - "whatever seems right will be right, and that only means we cannot talk of 'right' here." The beetle-in-a-box (PI 293) makes the point unforgettable: if the word "beetle" gets its use publicly, then *whatever is privately in the box* "drops out as irrelevant."

Term	Plain meaning
Logically private	in principle unknowable to anyone else, not merely secret
Diary "S" (PI 258)	naming a private sensation fails for lack of a correctness check
Correctness vs seeming	"seems right" is not "is right"; a rule needs an independent standard
Beetle-in-a-box (PI 293)	the private object drops out of the language-game as irrelevant
Public criteria	words for sensations get their sense from public circumstances

🔑 **Mnemonic - "DBC":** Diary (no check) -> Beetle (object irrelevant) -> Criteria must be public.

5. THE CRITIQUE OF PRIVATE LANGUAGE ✅ (PYQ 2024, 2019)

5.1 What is a "Private Language"? ✅

A **private language** in Wittgenstein's sense is one whose words refer to **the speaker's immediate private sensations** — sensations that are *logically* private (not merely contingently secret). The words would get their meaning from the private inner experience and could *in principle* not be taught to or understood by another. ✅

⚠️ **UPSC Trap — crucial clarification:** The private-language argument does NOT target: - A secret code (which could in principle be deciphered by another) — this is merely an encrypted public language. - Talking to oneself. - Having private thoughts.

It targets the *logical possibility* of a language whose meaning is constituted by private ostensive definition of inner sensations — the Cartesian/empiricist dream of grounding all meaning in *my* private experience.

5.2 The Diary Argument ("S") ✓

Suppose I decide to keep a diary of a certain recurring sensation. I write "S" each time the sensation occurs. To use "S" correctly, I must *re-identify* the same sensation each time. But:

1. There is **no independent criterion** of correctness — no public check, no physical correlation, nothing *outside* the private experience to settle whether today's sensation is the *same* as yesterday's.
2. **"Whatever seems right to me IS right"** — but that only means **we cannot talk about 'right' here**. The distinction between *correctly applying* the sign and *merely thinking* one applies it correctly **collapses**. ✓
3. Without a genuine rule of use (with a real correct/incorrect distinction), "S" has **no meaning**. The private diarist is under the *illusion* of using a sign meaningfully.

✓ "If whatever seems right to me is right, that only means that here we can't talk about 'right'."
(Investigations §258, in substance)

5.3 The Beetle-in-a-Box ✓

✓ Suppose everyone has a box that only they can look into; each calls its content "beetle." No one can see into anyone else's box. What role does the "object in the box" play in the *language-game* of using "beetle"?

Analysis: None. The word "beetle" gets its meaning from the *public* language-game — the circumstances of utterance, the reactions of others, the criteria of application. The private object **"drops out of consideration as irrelevant"** — it might be different for each person, or empty, or constantly changing. Meaning cannot be grounded in a private object. ✓

5.4 The Criterion of Correctness Objection (Core Logic) ⚠

The *logical core* of the private-language argument:

1. A meaningful sign requires a RULE OF USE (a standard of correct/incorrect application).
2. A rule of use requires a CRITERION OF CORRECTNESS independent of mere seeming.
3. A purely private "rule" has NO such independent criterion (the subject is sole judge;
whatever seems right IS right → no distinction between right and seems-right).
4. Therefore, a purely private "rule" is NOT a rule.
5. Therefore, private language (grounded in private ostensive definition) is IMPOSSIBLE.

5.5 What the Argument Demolishes

Target	How it falls
Cartesian dualism's private mind	If language cannot be private, then the meaning of sensation-words ("pain," "blue") must be grounded in <i>public</i> criteria (behaviour, context), not in private inner experience. The "inner theatre" cannot be the foundation of meaning.
Classical empiricism's private sense-data	If I cannot even <i>name</i> my private sense-data meaningfully, sense-data cannot serve as the epistemological foundation.
The referential theory of meaning (for sensations)	"Pain" does not get its meaning by referring to a private object called "pain." It gets its meaning from its place in public language-games involving pain-behaviour, expression, treatment, etc.
Solipsism (PYQ 2019 Q3(b))	If meaningful use requires standards beyond present private seeming, the solipsist's claim — "only my experience is real" — cannot even be <i>stated</i> meaningfully. The "I" of solipsism presupposes the public language it would deny. → The private-language argument <i>is</i> the critique of solipsism. 

5.6 Relation to Solipsism (PYQ 2019 Q3(b))

Wittgenstein's critique of solipsism is not a separate argument but a *consequence* of the private-language argument:

1. The solipsist claims: "Only my experiences are real; the external world and other minds may not exist."
2. But to make this claim, the solipsist must use language — and language requires standards not exhausted by a momentary private seeming.
3. The very language in which solipsism is expressed *presupposes* a public world and other speakers.
4. Therefore, solipsism is self-undermining — it tries to *say* what, if true, would make *saying* impossible.

 The *Tractatus* had already gestured at this: "What the solipsist *means* is quite correct, only it cannot be *said*" (5.62). The later Wittgenstein makes the impossibility of private language the explicit ground for why it cannot be said — or even thought coherently.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW — Private Language: Exact Target, Private Ostension and the Diary S

SUBTOPIC: Private Language: Exact Target, Private Ostension and the Diary S

STARTING CONCEPT: Private Language: Exact Target, Private Ostension and the Diary S

KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS: private language | private ostensive definition | diary S | memory sample | criterion of correction | essential privacy

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Private sensation + inward pointing -> sign S -> later memory comparison -> no distinction between correct and seeming-correct -> no privately constituted rule of use.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The Cartesian or empiricist inner object cannot serve as an autonomous semantic foundation.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not claim that bad memory alone proves the case, that all diaries are impossible, or that sensation and inner experience do not exist.

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The diary S fails not because memory is always unreliable but because an exclusively private memory impression cannot by itself constitute a standard that separates correctness from seeming.

SESSION 8 — Sensation Language: Criteria, Avowals, Beetle and the Anti-Behaviourist Reply

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Sensation language uses criteria and avowals: pain words are learned in public practices, but this neither makes pain unreal nor turns every pain utterance into a behavioural report.

Technical definition: A criterion is a grammatical circumstance that helps determine the application of a concept; evidence or a symptom supports an empirical inference. Criteria are defeasible and are not infallible behavioural signs. An avowal such as 'I am in pain' expresses pain and has a different grammatical role from a third-person report such as 'She is in pain', which uses outward circumstances. The beetle-in-the-box shows that a private object cannot fix the public word's grammar: the object drops out of the language-game, not out of existence; it is not a proof that sensations are unreal. Public criteria are standards of intelligibility, not majority voting.

VISUAL — Pain avowal versus third-person report

FIRST PERSON: 'I am in pain' -> AVOWAL / EXPRESSION

not inferred from observing my own behaviour

THIRD PERSON: 'She is in pain' -> ATTRIBUTION / REPORT

uses context, expression and outward criteria

The grammatical asymmetry blocks both Cartesian report theory and behaviourism.

VISUAL — Criterion, evidence and symptom

CRITERION -> grammatical ground for applying a concept; defeasible

EVIDENCE -> reason supporting a judgment in a case

SYMPTOM -> empirically correlated sign; revisable by investigation

NONE -> infallible identity between pain and bodily movement

The relation to the concept differs from an empirical sign.

VISUAL — Beetle-in-the-box: limited role

EACH SPEAKER has private box content called 'beetle'

PUBLIC PRACTICE proceeds without comparing private contents

v

PRIVATE OBJECT DROPS OUT OF THE WORD'S GRAMMAR

NOT: boxes are empty; NOT: sensations are unreal

The illustration concerns semantic role, not the non-existence of experience.

VISUAL — Private versus secret code

SECRET CODE -> rulebook exists -> translatable / teachable -> correct use
checkable

PRIVATE LANGUAGE -> no possible independent criterion -> seeming exhausts
correctness

SOLITUDE != ESSENTIAL PRIVACY; HEADCOUNT != NORMATIVITY

A secret code remains public-type because correctness can in principle be checked.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Wittgenstein is anti-Cartesian without being behaviourist: outward criteria organise the grammar of sensation concepts while avowals preserve first-person authority and inner experience.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **criterion**

- **empirical evidence**
- **symptom**
- **avowal**
- **first-person authority**
- **beetle-in-the-box**

How to use them: Define criterion, empirical evidence, symptom and avowal; contrast first-person authority with third-person report, then explain the beetle-in-the-box and anti-behaviourist reply.

CORE OBJECTION, REPLY AND RESIDUAL LIMIT

Objection: Phenomenological critics argue that public grammar cannot capture what pain feels like, while private-reference defenders claim first-person authority supplies an inner standard.

Best reply: The argument concerns the grammar and communicability of sensation concepts, not an exhaustive theory of phenomenology; avowals precisely mark the first-person asymmetry.

Residual limit: The residual question is whether public criteria can ground concepts while leaving qualitative character theoretically under-described.

EXAM USE AND CONCISE REVISION

Answer architecture: Use a two-column avowal/report diagram, then criterion/evidence and beetle; close with the anti-behaviourist thesis and the phenomenological remainder.

- Criterion is grammatical and defeasible; evidence is empirical and revisable.
- An avowal expresses pain; a third-person report attributes pain using circumstances.
- The beetle removes the private object from grammar, not sensation from reality.
- Public criteria do not mean infallibility, surveillance or majority rule.

Visual gateway - criteria vs symptoms

HOW DOES "PAIN" CONNECT TO BEHAVIOUR? two very different links

CRITERION	SYMPTOM
GRAMMATICAL link	INDUCTIVE / empirical link
fixes what the word MEANS	correlated by experience
wincing, crying, guarding = criteria for "pain"	e.g. a pallor we have learned often accompanies pain
DEFEASIBLE (can be overridden: acting)	can fail without touching meaning

PI 580: "An 'inner process' stands in need of outward criteria."
 angina analogy: some signs DEFINE (criteria), some merely ACCOMPANY (symptoms) - and the two can shift with knowledge.

Caption: behaviour is not evidence for a hidden thing; certain behaviour in context is part of what the sensation-word *means* - though defeasibly.

Plain-language start: If sensation-words are not fixed by a private object, how do they connect to the world? Through **criteria** - publicly available circumstances and behaviour that are part of the *grammar* (the meaning) of the word, not mere clues to a hidden thing. A **symptom**, by contrast, is something *experience* has taught us tends to accompany the state - an inductive correlation. Criteria are *grammatical* (they help fix meaning); symptoms are *empirical* (they are correlated). Both matter, and the same phenomenon can be a criterion in one context and a symptom in another. Crucially, criteria are **defeasible**: someone can wince and *not* be in pain (acting), and that possibility does not destroy the meaning-link - it is built into it. PI 580 compresses the whole idea: "An 'inner process' stands in need of outward criteria."

Term	Plain meaning
Criterion	a publicly available circumstance that partly <i>fixes the meaning</i> of a term (grammatical)
Symptom	something experience correlates with a state (inductive/empirical)
Defeasible	a criterion can be overridden in a case without ceasing to be a criterion
PI 580	"an inner process stands in need of outward criteria"
First-person asymmetry	I <i>avow</i> my pain ("It hurts"), I do not <i>observe</i> it by its criteria

🔑 **Mnemonic - "CGDS":** Criteria are **G**rammatical and **D**efeasible; **S**ymptoms are inductive.

5.7 CRITERIA vs SYMPTOMS ✅ — the distinction that saves the argument from behaviourism

Why you need it. Without this distinction the private-language argument looks like the claim that "pain" *means* pain-behaviour — i.e. behaviourism. With it, Wittgenstein can hold that the connection between behaviour and pain is **grammatical** (constitutive of the concept) without being **reductive** (an identity).

Exact printed subterms: *criterion* (*Kriterium*) · *symptom* (*Symptom*) · "**defining criterion**" · "**fluctuation in grammar between criteria and symptoms**" (PI §354) · *outward criteria* (§580) · *Lebensform* (form of life).

	CRITERION	SYMPTOM
Relation to the concept	Internal / grammatical — part of what it <i>is</i> for the concept to apply; fixed by convention and taught in learning the word	External / inductive — a correlation experience has taught us, discovered by observation
How established	By the grammar of the language-game; not by evidence	By empirical investigation
If it fails	We would not know what the word means any more — the concept would lose its footing	We would merely revise a generalisation; the concept is untouched

	CRITERION	SYMPTOM
Wittgenstein's own example (<i>Blue Book</i>)	For angina : the presence of a particular bacillus in the blood, which we have <i>defined</i> as the criterion	For angina : the inflamed throat , which experience has taught us usually goes with it
For pain	Pain-behaviour in appropriate circumstances is a criterion for "he is in pain"	A raised pulse, sweating, a groan produced by an actor — evidence at best

The three points that must be made ⚠️: 1. **Criteria are defeasible.** That pain-behaviour is a criterion does not mean it is conclusive: pretence, acting and suppression are all possible. Criteria give *non-inductive but defeasible* grounds. This is what blocks the inference to behaviourism. 2. **Criteria are not evidence for something hidden.** They are not clues from which we infer an inner event; they are the circumstances in which the concept has its home. 3. **The grammar fluctuates.** ✅ "In the practice of the use of language one party calls out the words, the other acts on them... The fluctuation in grammar between criteria and symptoms makes it look as if there were nothing at all but symptoms" (PI §354, in substance). What is a criterion in one language-game may be a symptom in another; the distinction is not a fixed taxonomy but a grammatical role.

5.8 "AN INNER PROCESS STANDS IN NEED OF OUTWARD CRITERIA" — PI §580 ✅

✅ "An 'inner process' stands in need of outward criteria." (*Philosophical Investigations* §580)

This one sentence is the hinge of the entire treatment of mind, and it is the single most quotable line in this file. Note precisely what it says and does not say:

It does say	It does not say
That the concept of an inner process has application only where there are outward criteria for its application	That there are no inner processes
That "remembering," "intending," "expecting," "understanding" are not names of private episodes we then report	That mental life is nothing but behaviour
That the <i>grammar</i> of psychological words is fixed in public practice	That my pain is <i>someone else's</i> business, or that I infer my own pain from my behaviour ⚠️ first-person asymmetry: I do not use criteria in my own case at all — I simply avow

The argument, numbered: 1. To possess a concept is to master a technique of applying a word correctly and incorrectly (§§143–202). 2. Mastery requires that there be circumstances in which application is right and circumstances in which it is wrong. 3. For a putatively "inner" concept, those circumstances cannot themselves be further inner items — that would restart the same problem one level down (a private criterion for a private criterion). 4. therefore the circumstances must be outward — behaviour, situation, what precedes and follows, the surroundings that Wittgenstein calls the "**surroundings**" or *Umgebung* of the utterance. 5. therefore an inner process stands in need of outward criteria.

5.9 THE BEHAVIOURISM CHARGE — AND THE REPLY ✅ (PI §§304, 307–308)

Wittgenstein raises the objection **against himself**, in the interlocutor's voice, which is why quoting it is so effective:

✓ "Aren't you at bottom really saying that everything except human behaviour is a fiction?" — "If I do speak of a fiction, then it is of a grammatical fiction." (§307, in substance)

The reply, in four moves ⚠️: 1. **The denial is of a picture, not of a phenomenon.** What is rejected is the model of sensation as an **inner object** privately named — not the reality of pain, joy or memory. §304: "It is **not a something, but not a nothing either!** The conclusion was only that a nothing would serve just as well as a something about which nothing could be said." 2. **The first false step.** §308 diagnoses how the problem arises: we begin by talking innocently of mental "processes and states" while leaving their nature undecided — "and now the analogy which was to make us understand our thoughts falls to pieces... **the decisive movement in the conjuring trick has been made, and it was the very one that we thought quite innocent.**" 3. **Criteria ≠ definition.** Because criteria are defeasible (§5.7), "he is in pain" is not *equivalent to* any statement about behaviour. The behaviourist asserts an equivalence; Wittgenstein asserts a grammatical dependence. **This is the whole difference, and stating it is what an examiner is looking for.** 4. **The first/third person asymmetry.** The behaviourist must treat "I am in pain" and "he is in pain" symmetrically. Wittgenstein does not: the first-person utterance is not a report based on criteria but an **avowal** (*Äußerung*) which replaces the natural expression of pain — a cry — rather than describing an inner object (§244).

⚠️ **Verdict to deploy:** Wittgenstein is anti-Cartesian without being reductively behaviourist: he rejects private-object grounding while retaining sensations and first-person avowals; criterial grammar's adequacy remains disputed.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW — Sensation Language: Criteria, Avowals, Beetle and the Anti-Behaviourist Reply

SUBTOPIC: Sensation Language: Criteria, Avowals, Beetle and the Anti-Behaviourist Reply

STARTING CONCEPT: Sensation Language: Criteria, Avowals, Beetle and the Anti-Behaviourist Reply

KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS: criterion | empirical evidence | symptom | avowal | first-person authority | beetle-in-the-box

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Natural pain-expression -> training in pain-word -> avowal in first person; outward circumstances -> criterion-guided third-person judgment; private object is not semantic ground.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Sensation language remains meaningful without treating inner episodes as privately named objects or reducing them to overt bodily movement.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Never say the beetle proves sensations do not exist, criteria are conclusive symptoms, or the majority decides whether a person is in pain.

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Wittgenstein is anti-Cartesian without being

behaviourist: outward criteria organise the grammar of sensation concepts while avowals preserve first-person authority and inner experience.

SESSION 9 — Philosophical Therapy and Perspicuous Representation: Description with Limits

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Philosophical therapy uses perspicuous representation to arrange familiar uses so that a misleading picture loses its grip rather than being replaced by a hidden entity or law.

Technical definition: Philosophical therapy is the treatment of conceptual confusion through description, reminders, comparisons and perspicuous representation: an arrangement that lets us see connections in grammar. When language idles or 'goes on holiday', surface similarities tempt us to ask questions outside a word's home practice. The fly-bottle image describes release from a self-generated trap. Therapy is neither empirical science nor arbitrary quietism; it is local, plural and diagnostic, though 'leaves everything as it is' creates a real conservatism and self-application worry.

VISUAL — Therapeutic method

WORD REMOVED FROM HOME USE / MISLEADING ANALOGY

v

PHILOSOPHICAL DISORIENTATION: 'I do not know my way about'

v

REMINDERS + COMPARISONS + PERSPICUOUS REPRESENTATION

v

SEE CONNECTIONS -> PICTURE LOSES GRIP -> FLY FINDS EXIT

The sequence moves from captive picture to a surveyable view and release.

VISUAL — Description, science and quietism

EMPIRICAL SCIENCE -> explains and predicts events

THERAPY -> describes grammar and dissolves a conceptual knot

ARBITRARY QUIETISM -> refuses argument without diagnosis

SOCIAL CRITIQUE -> first-order practice not automatically prohibited

The method is local conceptual work, not a ban on all explanation or criticism.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Wittgensteinian therapy changes our view of the grammatical terrain rather than adding a theory behind it, but its refusal of explanation must itself be defended against quietism.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **philosophical therapy**
- **perspicuous representation**
- **reminders**
- **description**
- **language on holiday**
- **fly-bottle**

How to use them: Define philosophical therapy and perspicuous representation, then connect reminders, description, language on holiday and the fly-bottle to quietism and self-application.

CORE OBJECTION, REPLY AND RESIDUAL LIMIT

Objection: The method can seem unfalsifiable: a persistent problem is treated as evidence that the right reminders have not yet been supplied.

Best reply: Local grammatical diagnosis can be assessed by whether it reveals equivocation, crossed games or a captive picture; it need not forbid first-order science, ethics or political criticism.

Residual limit: A complete account of which problems are genuinely grammatical, and why description is sufficient, remains difficult without advancing something like a philosophical thesis.

EXAM USE AND CONCISE REVISION

Answer architecture: Answer with diagnosis -> tools -> fly-bottle mechanism -> local scope -> quietism objection -> reply -> residual self-reference limit.

- Perspicuous representation shows connections; it is not decorative summary.
- Therapy uses reminders and descriptions rather than hidden causal explanation.
- The fly-bottle is a model of self-generated conceptual entrapment.
- Quietism is a serious limit, not a reason to ignore the method's diagnostic power.

Visual gateway - the therapy map (out of the fly-bottle)

HOW PHILOSOPHICAL PROBLEMS ARISE, AND DISSOLVE

(1) language "goes on HOLIDAY" - a word idles, torn from its home language-game ("What is TIME?" with no ordinary use)

|

(2) we are BEWITCHED: "philosophy is a battle against the bewitchment of our intelligence by means of language"

|

(3) THERAPY = DESCRIBE the ordinary use; assemble reminders; build a PERSPICUOUS (surveyable) representation (PI 122)

|

(4) the problem DISSOLVES (it is not solved by a theory):
"to show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle" (PI 309)

"Philosophy may in no way interfere with the actual use of language; it can in the end only describe it. ... it leaves everything as it is." (PI 124)

Caption: the aim is not a doctrine but relief - a clear view that makes the false problem disappear.

Plain-language start: Why do philosophical puzzles feel so deep and so stuck? Because a word has "gone on holiday" - lifted out of the ordinary activity where it works and made to spin ("What is *time*? What is *meaning*? Where is the *self*?"). We get "bewitched" by our own language. Wittgenstein's therapy is not to build a rival theory but to *bring the words home*: describe their ordinary use, assemble reminders, and arrange them into a **perspicuous (surveyable) representation** so we "command a clear view" and the knot unties itself. The image is unforgettable - philosophy's aim is "to show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle." And because it only describes, "philosophy leaves everything as it is."

Term	Plain meaning
Language on holiday	a word idling away from its home language-game breeds pseudo-problems
Bewitchment	philosophical confusion is language misleading the intellect
Perspicuous representation (PI 122)	arranging what we know so we "see connexions" - the positive method
Fly-bottle (PI 309)	therapy = showing the fly the way out; dissolving, not solving
Leaves everything as it is (PI 124)	philosophy describes; it advances no theses and changes nothing

 **Mnemonic - "HBPF":** Holiday -> Bewitchment -> Perspicuous view -> Fly-bottle exit.

3.5 Philosophical Consequence — Therapy ✓

✓ "Philosophy is a battle against the bewitchment of our intelligence by means of language."
(*Investigations* §109)

Philosophical problems arise when **language goes on holiday** — when a term is torn from its home language-game and deployed in a context where it has no established use. "Where does the flame go when it goes out?" "What is time in itself?" These are not profound questions awaiting solution; they are symptoms of linguistic confusion.

✓ "Philosophy leaves everything as it is." (*Investigations* §124)

Philosophy does not *discover* new facts or build theories. It *describes* the workings of language and thereby *dissolves* the puzzlement that arises from misusing it. This is the **therapeutic** conception. ✓

5A. PHILOSOPHY AS THERAPY — LANGUAGE ON HOLIDAY AND THE FLY-BOTTLE ✓

Thesis. Philosophical problems are not questions awaiting discoveries; they are **confusions** produced when language is taken out of the practice that gives it sense. The method is therefore **diagnostic and dissolving**, not constructive.

The five load-bearing images and remarks ✓: | Remark | PI § | What it does | |---|---|---| |
"Philosophical problems arise when language goes on holiday" (*wenn die Sprache feiert* — literally when language *idles*, is not at work) | §38 | Locates the origin of the problem: a word removed from its language-game keeps its surface grammar but loses its use | | "A picture held us captive. And we could not get outside it, for it lay in our language and language seemed to repeat it to us inexorably." | §115 | Names the mechanism: a *Bild* — the inner object, the essence, the hidden mechanism of meaning | | "A philosophical problem has the form: 'I don't know my way about.'" (*Ich kenne mich nicht aus*) | §123 | Reclassifies the difficulty: it is **disorientation**, not ignorance of a fact | | "The philosopher's treatment of a question is like the treatment of an illness." | §255 | The therapeutic analogy stated outright | | ✓
"What is your aim in philosophy? — To show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle." (*der Fliege den Ausweg aus dem Fliegenglas zeigen*) | §309 | The governing image of the whole method |

Reading the fly-bottle image correctly ⚠ (this is where marks are won or lost): 1. The fly-bottle image depicts a self-sustaining route of conceptual entrapment — the fly is not physically imprisoned. Nothing holds it but its own manner of trying to escape: it batters at the glass, which is transparent, because it can see the outside. 2. therefore the philosopher's predicament is **self-generated**. The exit was always available. 3. therefore the remedy is not a new theory but a change in how one goes about it — showing the *way out*, not supplying an *answer*. 4. therefore there is no philosophical thesis to replace the confused one: "Philosophy... leaves everything as it is" (§124); "If one tried to advance theses in philosophy, it would never be possible to debate them, because everyone would agree to them" (§128). 5. therefore success is measured by **cessation**, not by discovery: "The real discovery is the one that makes me capable of stopping doing philosophy when I want to" (§133).

Presuppositions ⚠️: (P1) every genuine question has a home in some practice; (P2) philosophical theses that survive scrutiny are grammatical remarks in disguise; (P3) description suffices — **"we may not advance any kind of theory. There must not be anything hypothetical in our considerations. We must do away with all *explanation*, and description alone must take its place"** (§109).

Strongest objections → **replies** ? : | Objection | Reply | Residual | |---|---|---| | **Quietism/conservatism:** "leaves everything as it is" removes philosophy's critical function, including social critique. | The claim concerns *conceptual* description, not social practice; therapy removes confusion and does not forbid reform. | ⚠️ But the range of what philosophy may legitimately do is deliberately and severely narrowed; the charge is not fully answered. | | **Self-application:** the therapeutic method is itself a philosophical thesis about philosophy, so it refutes itself. | Wittgenstein accepts a version of this: his remarks are themselves ladder-like, and §133 speaks of **"methods**, like different therapies," in the plural — there is no single doctrine. | ? Structurally the same problem as the *Tractatus* ladder — continuity between early and late Wittgenstein on this precise point is a first-class exam observation. | | Some philosophical problems are real (personal identity, free will, the status of mathematics) and survive any amount of grammatical clarification. | Wittgenstein would treat their persistence as evidence that the picture holding us captive has not yet been fully exhibited. | ⚠️ Unfalsifiable as stated; this is the most serious methodological complaint. |

Authored bridge - "perspicuous representation" (PI 122). The canonical file describes the therapeutic method fully but does not use the textbook English label for its central positive tool, so it is supplied here for completeness. Wittgenstein calls the goal *eine übersichtliche Darstellung* - rendered as a **"perspicuous representation"** (also translated **"surveyable representation"**): an arrangement of the grammatical facts we already know so that we *command a clear view* of our use of words. "A perspicuous representation produces just that kind of understanding which consists in 'seeing connexions'." (PI 122) It is the antidote to the confusion the therapy treats: not new information, but a re-ordering of the familiar until the knot is visible and dissolves.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW — Philosophical Therapy and Perspicuous Representation: Description with Limits

SUBTOPIC: Philosophical Therapy and Perspicuous Representation: Description with Limits

STARTING CONCEPT: Philosophical Therapy and Perspicuous Representation: Description with Limits

KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS: philosophical therapy | perspicuous representation | reminders | description | language on holiday | fly-bottle

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Misleading analogy or idle word -> philosophical disorientation -> compare language-games and assemble reminders -> perspicuous view -> grip of problem weakens.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Philosophy becomes a set of therapies whose success is clarity and the ability to stop, not a single scientific or metaphysical explanatory system.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not present therapy as refusal to think, automatic defence of existing institutions, or the claim that every philosophical problem is

verbal in a trivial sense.

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Wittgensteinian therapy changes our view of the grammatical terrain rather than adding a theory behind it, but its refusal of explanation must itself be defended against quietism.

SESSION 10 — Comparative Synthesis, Criticism and Answer Architecture

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The later philosophy is best assessed by comparing its method and distinctions with the early project, then testing whether practice can carry meaning, normativity and mind.

Technical definition: The synthesis contrasts name/object/logical form with practice/grammar/family resemblance; saying/showing with therapeutic dissolution; and ideal analysis with perspicuous description. Later Wittgenstein influences ordinary-language philosophy, philosophy of mind, rule-following and anti-essentialism. Limitations include conservatism, relativism, under-explanation of normativity, apparent strain with scientific and theoretical language, and incomplete treatment of private experience. Exact examination distinctions include criterion/evidence, symptom/criterion, private/secret, rule/regularity, use/intention, grammar/empirical fact and agreement/majority. Aspect-seeing, certainty, religion and post-Wittgensteinian debates are enrichment rather than prerequisites for the core.

VISUAL — Early and later Wittgenstein comparison

EARLY: object/name | logical form | picture | ideal analysis | saying/showing

LATER: practice | grammar | use | language-games | family resemblance | therapy

CONTINUITY: philosophy clarifies limits and resists traditional system-building

DISCONTINUITY: source of sense and mode of clarification are transformed

The comparison joins doctrines, method and treatment of philosophical limits.

VISUAL — Exact distinction checklist

criterion != evidence

symptom != criterion

private != secret

rule != regularity

use != intention

grammar != empirical fact

agreement in judgments != majority vote

Each pair blocks a recurrent examiner trap.

VISUAL — Criticism and reply map

QUIETISM -> local therapy does not ban first-order critique -> scope still disputed

RELATIVISM -> shared human practices enable comparison -> norm remains under-theorised

BEHAVIOURISM -> criteria are defeasible; avowal asymmetry -> phenomenology remains

SCIENCE -> theories are trained practices -> ordinary examples may under-explain them

NORMATIVITY -> correction in practice -> explanation versus description worry remains

A qualified evaluation preserves both diagnostic power and unresolved limits.

VISUAL — Philosophy Optional answer spine

THESIS + TEXTUAL QUALIFICATION

-> DEFINE TECHNICAL TERMS

-> RECONSTRUCT MECHANISM WITH PI EXAMPLE

-> DRAW EXACT DISTINCTIONS

-> OBJECTION + SERIOUS REPLY + RESIDUAL LIMIT

-> EARLY/LATER OR SCHOOL COMPARISON

-> QUALIFIED VERDICT

The rail scales from a short answer to a critical twenty-marker.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

A comparative synthesis of Later Wittgenstein supports a precise answer architecture: his anti-essentialist method clarifies language and mind, although practice under-explains normativity.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **comparative synthesis**
- **answer architecture**
- **ordinary-language philosophy**
- **anti-essentialism**
- **criterion and evidence**
- **rule and regularity**
- **grammar and empirical fact**

How to use them: Build comparative synthesis through ordinary-language philosophy and anti-essentialism, then use criterion/evidence, rule/regularity and grammar/empirical fact in the answer architecture.

CORE OBJECTION, REPLY AND RESIDUAL LIMIT

Objection: The method may conserve inherited grammar, understate theory and science, and leave normativity or phenomenology unexplained.

Best reply: Its defenders distinguish conceptual elucidation from empirical explanation and show that scientific language is also a trained practice; critics rightly retain the explanatory remainder.

Residual limit: The best verdict is domain-sensitive: powerful against essentialist and private-foundation pictures, less complete as a general semantic, social or scientific theory.

EXAM USE AND CONCISE REVISION

Answer architecture: For 10 marks use thesis + one mechanism + distinction + verdict; for 15 add objection/reply; for 20 integrate transition, full core chain, comparison and residual limit.

- Early/late comparison must include both continuity and discontinuity.
- Contribution: ordinary language, mind, rule-following and anti-essentialism.
- Limits: quietism, relativism, normativity, science and private experience.
- Exact distinctions are answer-scoring devices, not a detachable glossary.

Visual gateway - the duck-rabbit

THE DUCK-RABBIT (Jastrow's figure, PI Part II xi / PPF)

/	—	'-.	look LEFT -> a DUCK's bill
(	o	>	(the two marks point away)
\	—	-'	look RIGHT -> a RABBIT's ears

' ' ' (the same marks are ears)
 SAME lines on the page. The DRAWING does not change.
 What changes is the ASPECT under which you SEE it.

 "Now I see it as a rabbit" = SEEING-AS (seeing an aspect)
 the sudden switch = the DAWNING of an aspect ("Now a duck!")
 someone who could never switch = ASPECT-BLIND
 half experience / half thought: "'seeing as ...' is not part
 of perception. And for that reason it is like seeing, and
 again not like seeing."

Caption: perception is not the passive intake of raw data; how we see is shot through with concepts, technique and mastery.

Plain-language start: Look at Jastrow's duck-rabbit: the very same marks are now a duck, now a rabbit. Nothing on the paper changed - what changed is the *aspect* you see it under. Wittgenstein calls this **seeing-as** or **seeing an aspect**, and the sudden flip - "now it's a rabbit!" - the **dawning of an aspect**. Someone who could never experience the switch would be **aspect-blind**. The lesson reaches back into the whole philosophy: seeing is not just receiving raw data and then interpreting; the *concepts and techniques we have mastered are already in the seeing*. Aspect-seeing is "half visual experience, half thought" - and it is *not* the same as forming an interpretation or inference.

Term	Plain meaning
Seeing-as / seeing an aspect	seeing something <i>as</i> a duck, <i>as</i> a rabbit - concept in the perception
Dawning of an aspect	the sudden switch, "now I see it as..."
Aspect-blindness	inability to experience aspect-change (a limiting notion)
Not an interpretation	aspect-seeing is a mode of <i>experience</i> , not a theory-laden inference

 **Mnemonic - "SAD-N":** Seeing-As, Dawning of aspect, Not interpretation (aspect-blind is the limit case).

5B. ASPECT-SEEING AND THE DUCK-RABBIT (*Investigations, Part II §xi / "Philosophy of Psychology — A Fragment"*)

Why it belongs in this file. Aspect-seeing is where the later philosophy shows that even *perception* is not a bare given but is internally bound up with mastery of concepts and techniques. It completes the demolition of the sense-datum foundation that Russell and the positivists built on, and it explains the "experience of meaning."

The phenomenon. Jastrow's **duck-rabbit** figure can be seen as a duck or as a rabbit. Wittgenstein's crucial observation:

✓ "I see that it has not changed; and yet I see it differently."

The puzzle, numbered: 1. Nothing in the drawing alters — the lines, the ink and the retinal image are identical before and after. 2. Yet something genuinely changes: I now see a **rabbit** where I saw a **duck**. Wittgenstein calls this the **dawning of an aspect** (*das Aufleuchten eines Aspekts*). 3. So the change is neither in the object (nothing physical altered) nor merely in my *interpretation* (I do not *infer* the rabbit — the change is immediate and visual). 4. therefore "Seeing-as" is a **third** category, neither pure perception nor pure judgement: it is "half visual experience, half thought." 5. therefore concepts are not applied *after* perception; the ability to see the aspect **presupposes mastery of a technique** — Wittgenstein notes that one must be familiar with the shape of a rabbit to see the rabbit-aspect at all. 6. therefore **Aspect-blindness**: we can conceive of someone who has full visual acuity, and can identify both figures on request, yet is incapable of the *dawning* of an aspect. Such a person's relation to meaning would also be impoverished — which is why aspect-seeing illuminates the **experience of meaning** (hearing a word "in a particular sense," feeling a word to "fit").

Consequences to deploy ⚠ : | Target | Damage done | |---|---| | **Sense-data / the Given** | If what I see depends on what I can do with concepts, no perceptual layer is conceptually innocent. The Russellian foundation of acquaintance is undermined from a new direction — see Moore-Russell-
EarlyWittgenstein.md §4.7. || **The picture theory** | A picture does not depict *of itself*; it depicts only within a practice of use. The *Tractatus* had assumed that the picturing relation was intrinsic to the picture. This is a self-criticism. || **Meaning as inner process** | The dawning of an aspect *feels* like an inner event, yet its criteria are what one does and says next. §580 applies here as elsewhere. || **Philosophy's own method** | Wittgenstein's therapy just **is** the attempt to make a new aspect dawn — to make us see the familiar language-game differently, without adding a single new fact. This is the deepest connection between §5B and §5A, and it is worth an explicit sentence in any answer on his method. |

CLOSING RECALL FLOW — Comparative Synthesis, Criticism and Answer Architecture

SUBTOPIC: Comparative Synthesis, Criticism and Answer Architecture

STARTING CONCEPT: Comparative Synthesis, Criticism and Answer Architecture

KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS: comparative synthesis | answer architecture | ordinary-language philosophy | anti-essentialism | criterion and evidence | rule and regularity | grammar and empirical fact

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Fair reconstruction of transition ->

use/games/rules/private-language mechanism -> precise distinctions -> objections and replies -> qualified contribution and residual limits.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A coherent answer can connect the entire syllabus without turning Wittgenstein into either a behaviourist, relativist, verificationist or universal theory-builder.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not end with an unqualified celebration or rejection, and never collapse criteria into evidence, agreement into majority, or use into intention.

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: A comparative synthesis of Later Wittgenstein

supports a precise answer architecture: his anti-essentialist method clarifies language and mind, although practice under-explains normativity.

REVIEW-PROMOTED LATER-WITTGENSTEIN SYSTEM AND BOUNDARY COMPLETENESS

Source and owner scope

- The owner is *Investigations*-era meaning/use, language-games and private language. Early *Tractatus* material appears only for routed transition demands.
- *On Certainty*, aspect-seeing, religious language and Ryle/Austin/Strawson/Quine comparisons are bounded enrichment or cross-owned.
- The 2022 “motion” typo and 2025 unmatched quotation mark must be preserved before interpretation.

Meaning, ostension and games

- §43 says “for a large class of cases—though not for all.” Use is not dictionary definition, frequency, utility or private choice.
- Ostensive definition needs background training that fixes whether the sample teaches colour, shape, number or material.
- Family resemblance denies a required single essence, not all shared properties or normative boundaries.
- Language-games are language woven into activity; the game analogy does not imply arbitrary invention or explicit rulebooks everywhere.
- Form-of-life agreement enables correction/disagreement and does not automatically entail cultural relativism.

Rules, private language and mind

- Rule-following cannot be interpretation all the way down; trained practice displays normativity without reducing it to regularity or majority vote.
- Private language targets logically private ostensive grounding, not secret codes, solitude, thoughts or sensations.
- Diary S fails because right collapses into seems-right; no actual community observer is required.
- The beetle's hidden item has no role in the stipulated shared use; the analogy does not deny inner experience.
- Criteria are grammatical and defeasible; symptoms are empirical. Present first-person avowals differ from third-person reports without reducing pain to behaviour.

Therapy and boundaries

- Grammatical investigation uses reminders and perspicuous representation to expose surface/depth category confusions.
- “Leaves everything as it is” concerns grammar, not automatic political conservatism.
- Colour exclusion pressures rather than instantly refutes every possible early analysis.

- Logical Positivism's verification criterion and broader ordinary-language programmes remain distinct.

MEANING: QUALIFIED USE -> TRAINING/OSTENSION -> LANGUAGE-GAME/FORM OF LIFE
 NORMATIVITY: RULE -> PRACTICE/CORRECTION, NOT INTERPRETATION OR MAJORITY
 PRIVATE LANGUAGE: LOGICAL PRIVACY -> NO RIGHT/SEEMS-RIGHT DISTINCTION
 MIND: CRITERIA + AVOWALS -> ANTI-CARTESIAN, NOT BEHAVIOURIST
 PHILOSOPHY: GRAMMATICAL THERAPY, WITH QUIETISM/RELATIVISM PRESSURES

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

RAPID REVISION 1 — The Break from the Tractatus - Placement, the One-Screen Map and Why the Later Philosophy Begins

Rapid recall

- Two Wittgensteins: *Tractatus* (1921, picturing) vs *Investigations* (1953, use). Same author, opposed pictures of meaning.
- Four flips: picturing -> **use**; one essence -> **family resemblance**; one general factual form -> **varied ordinary practices**; private reference -> private ostension cannot found a language. - Reasons for the shift: **colour-exclusion problem (1929)**, the **Augustinian picture** is too narrow, philosophy needs **description not theory**. - Method slogan: "**Don't think, but look.**" Philosophy **describes**, it does not explain. - **Provenance trap**: the *Investigations* was published posthumously in 1953; Anscombe translated and edited with Rhees; do not say "Wittgenstein published" it. - Ownership: **7** owned parts 2018-2025; **2021** is the empty year. - **Practice link**: MCQs 1-5; PYQs 2023 Q4(c), 2025 Q3(a).

RAPID REVISION 2 — Meaning as Use - the Toolbox, the PI 43 Qualification and Mastery of a Technique

Rapid recall

- Thesis (PI 43): **the meaning of a word is its use in the language** - "for a large class of cases - **though not for all**" (quote the hedge). - Words are **tools in a toolbox**: ask the job, not the object. "The", "if", "five", "pain" have no object. - **Understanding = mastery of a technique** = being able to *go on* correctly; a public ability, not a private image.
- Meaning is **context-dependent** - fixed by the language-game ("Water!"). - **Trap**: flattening section 43 into "all meaning is use"; treating use-theory as a new *theory* Wittgenstein endorses.
- **Practice link**: MCQs 6-10; PYQs 2023 Q4(c), 2025 Q3(a), 2026 Q3(c).

RAPID REVISION 3 — Family Resemblance - Overlapping Similarities, Fuzzy Boundaries and 'Don't Think, But Look'

Rapid recall

- **Games** share no single feature - only "a complicated network of similarities overlapping and criss-crossing". Model: a **family** (nose, gait, temperament). - Consequence: **concepts need not have sharp boundaries**; definitions by necessary-and-sufficient conditions are not always possible - and that is fine. - Method: "**Don't think, but look!**" - describe the variety, do not posit an essence. - **Bridge**: because "game" has no essence, "language is a game" does not smuggle one in - it dissolves the search. (2018 link.) - **Trap**: treating "family resemblance" as itself the shared property; demanding sharp edges. - **Practice link**: MCQs 11-14; PYQ 2018 Q1(c).
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RAPID REVISION 4 — Language-Games - Language Woven into Activity, the Builders and Rules by Training

Rapid recall

- **Language-game (Sprachspiel)** = language + the activities into which it is woven; **countless** games, norm-governed through practice, often without explicit rulebooks. - **Builders' example**: "Slab!" -> brings a slab; a **complete** primitive language, not a broken bit of ours - meaning needs trained practical role; no single picturing form exhausts language.
 - **Rules by training** (drill, example, correction), not by grasping a Platonic essence or hidden calculus. - Language is **living**: games are born and die. - **Chain**: many games -> no essence (family resemblance) -> rules by practice -> forms of life. - **Practice link**: MCQs 15-19; PYQs 2018 Q1(c), 2022 Q1(c), 2025 Q3(a).
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RAPID REVISION 5 — Forms of Life - PI 19, Agreement in Form of Life, the Lion Remark and the Bedrock of Justification

Rapid recall

- **PI 19**: "To imagine a language means to imagine a **form of life**." (Lebensform) - **Agreement in form of life, not in opinion** - shared *doing*, not shared beliefs; blocks both relativist and intellectualist misreadings.
 - **Lion remark**: too different a form of life -> no understanding, even with speech. - **Bedrock**: "This is simply what I do" - justification ends in practice; forms of life are "the given". - **2022 anomaly**: the printed word is "**motion**" (retained), read as "notion". - **Trap**: turning forms of life into cultural relativism; the background is largely *natural*.
 - **Practice link**: MCQs 20-24; PYQ 2022 Q1(c).
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RAPID REVISION 6 — Rule-Following and the Paradox (PI 201) - Interpretation Regress, Practice and Going On

Rapid recall

- **PI 201 paradox:** "no course of action could be determined by a rule, because every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule." - **Regress point:** you cannot fix a rule by adding an interpretation - that needs its own rule, forever. - **Resolution:** grasping a rule is "**not an interpretation**" but is **exhibited in obeying**; rule-following is a **practice/custom** grounded in training and form of life. - **Normativity kept:** right/wrong survives, fixed by shared practice, not private seeming. - **Bridge:** public criterion of correctness -> **no private rule -> no private language.**
 - **Interpretive flag: Kripkenstein** = sceptical paradox + community solution; a reading, contested by Baker/Hacker - keep labelled. - **Practice link:** MCQs 25-30; feeds PYQs 2019 Q3(b), 2024 Q1(d), 2020 Q4(c).
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RAPID REVISION 7 — The Private-Language Argument - Logical Privacy, the Diary 'S', the Beetle and Public Criteria

Rapid recall

- **Private language (exact target):** words for **logically private** sensations, unintelligible to others *in principle* - NOT a code, NOT talking to yourself.
 - **Diary 258:** name a private sensation "S"; no independent check of "same" -> "whatever seems right is right" -> "we can't talk about 'right'." No possible mistake -> no meaning. - **Beetle 293:** private object "drops out as irrelevant"; "the box might even be empty." Meaning is carried by criterion-governed use. - **Public criteria:** sensation-words get sense from public circumstances (feeds subtopic 8). - **Solipsism (2019):** the critique of solipsism *culminates in* the critique of private language - the private world cannot even be said.
 - **Trap:** it does NOT deny inner life or claim "we can't know other minds." - **Practice link:** MCQs 31-38; PYQs 2019 Q3(b), 2020 Q4(c), 2024 Q1(d).
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RAPID REVISION 8 — Criteria vs Symptoms, PI 580 Outward Criteria and the Behaviourism Charge Answered

Rapid recall

- **Criterion = grammatical** (helps fix meaning, *defeasible*); **symptom = inductive** (experience-correlated). Not a difference of degree. - **PI 580:** "An 'inner process' stands in need of **outward criteria**." States grammar; does not deny the inner. - **Defeasibility** is the anti-behaviourism hinge: wincing without pain (acting) is possible -> pain != pain-behaviour -> **not behaviourism.** - **Behaviourism reply (PI 304, 307-308):** Wittgenstein rejects the inner *object* as semantic foundation ("grammatical fiction"), **not** the inner life - "not a something, but not a nothing either." - **First-person avowal:** "It hurts" is an *expression*, not a criterion-based report; criteria govern the third-person case (asymmetry).

- **Trap:** "criteria are reliable symptoms" (collapses grammar into induction). - **Practice link:** MCQs 39-43; feeds PYQs 2020 Q4(c), 2019 Q3(b), 2026 Q3(c).

RAPID REVISION 9 — Philosophy as Therapy - Language on Holiday, the Fly-Bottle, Perspicuous Representation and 'Leaves Everything as It Is'

Rapid recall

- **Diagnosis:** "philosophical problems arise when **language goes on holiday**"; "philosophy is a battle against the **bewitchment** of our intelligence by means of language" (PI 109). - **Positive tool:** **perspicuous / surveyable representation** (PI 122, *übersichtliche Darstellung*) - arrange the familiar so we "see connexions".
- **Aim:** "to show the fly the way out of the **fly-bottle**" (PI 309) - problems are **dissolved**, not solved. - **Self-limit (quietism):** "philosophy **leaves everything as it is**" (PI 124); no theses (PI 128); "puts everything before us" (PI 126). - **Plurality:** "not a philosophical method, though there are... **different therapies**" (PI 133). - **Objection/reply:** "no theses" looks self-refuting -> reply: reminders, not metaphysics; success = intellectual peace. - **Practice link:** MCQs 44-47; closing segment for PYQs 2023 Q4(c), 2025 Q3(a).

RAPID REVISION 10 — Aspect-Seeing and the Duck-Rabbit - Seeing-As, the Dawning of an Aspect and Aspect-Blindness

Rapid recall

- **Duck-rabbit** (Jastrow; PI Part II xi / **PPF**): same marks, different **aspect**. The drawing does not change; the *seeing* does.
- **Seeing-as / seeing an aspect;** the flip = **dawning of an aspect**; the limit case = **aspect-blindness**. - "**Not part of perception... like seeing, and again not like seeing**" - it is **not an interpretation/inference**; the aspect is *experienced*.
- **Payload:** perception is **technique-laden** - the mastery behind meaning-as-use reaches into how we see; anti-empiricist about "bare data + interpretation". - **Meaning-blindness** parallel: experiencing a word with a particular meaning. - **Provenance:** cite **PPF / Part II xi**, credit **Jastrow**; not a numbered Part I remark. - **Practice link:** MCQs 48-51; enrichment for PYQ 2025 Q3(a) and the 2026 mental-ideas demand.

CANONICAL EXAM APPARATUS

The examiner apparatus below is reorganised from the canonical Later-Wittgenstein.md, with headings demoted and navigation links stripped. The validator checks specified anchors and witnesses; it does not certify word-for-word identity or semantic completeness.

Inter-Thinker / Inter-School Debates

Axis	Later Wittgenstein	Early Wittgenstein	Logical Positivism	Descartes / Empiricism
Meaning	Use in a form of life	Picturing facts (logical form)	Verification	Idea / private reference
Essence of language	None (family resemblance)	One logical form for all propositions	One criterion (verifiability)	Naming inner/outer objects
Metaphysics	Dissolve as language-on-holiday (therapy)	Show what cannot be said; be silent	Reject as meaningless	Pursue as first philosophy
Private inner realm	Private ostension cannot alone ground linguistic standards	Solipsism/self are treated at the limit of world and language	Not central	Foundational (cogito, sense-data)
Philosophy's task	Therapy — dissolve confusions; "leaves everything as it is"	Draw limits of the sayable	Analysis; eliminate pseudo-problems	Build system from foundations
Ethics	Embedded in forms of life; no philosophical theory needed	Beyond the sayable (the mystical)	Emotive / non-cognitive	Rational theory possible

Directive Decoder - What Each Command Word Obliges You To Do

Directive	What it demands	Structural obligation for this file	Fatal error
Discuss meaning as use	show the contrast it replaces , then the positive account	Augustinian/referential picture (§1) → use → family resemblance → forms of life. Give a worked example (the builders' "Slab!").	"Wittgenstein said meaning is use" plus a paraphrase.
Critically examine the private-language argument (2024, 2019)	reconstruct the five-step logical core , then the criteria/symptoms defence	§5.4 core, then the behaviourism charge with §§304–308 as the reply, then Kripke vs Hacker, then rule.	Retelling the beetle and the diary with no argument-structure.
Elucidate a numbered remark (quotation-led parts)	give the §, then the doctrine, then the work it does	E.g. §580 "an inner process stands in need of outward criteria": say what it does not claim (§5.8 table).	Paraphrasing the sentence.
How does Wittgenstein criticise solipsism? (2019 Q3b)	show it is a corollary , not a separate argument	Private ostension cannot fix every concept → solipsistic linguistic grounding is self-undermining. Add <i>Tractatus</i> 5.62 for the early/late contrast.	Treating it as an independent refutation.
Compare early and later Wittgenstein (2025 Q3a, 2023 Q4c)	name the specific doctrines abandoned and what caused each abandonment	Determinacy of sense, simple objects, one logical form, elementary independence (pressured by colour exclusion), sense as picturing.	"He changed his mind about language."

Directive	What it demands	Structural obligation for this file	Fatal error
Explain philosophy as therapy	show that the method follows from the diagnosis	§38 holiday → §115 picture → §123 disorientation → §309 fly-bottle → §124/§128/§133 consequences.	Quoting the fly-bottle with no account of why the bottle is open.
Assess "family resemblance"	show what it denies (essences) and what it permits (extensible concepts)	Games as the worked case; then the objection that unlimited resemblance makes any two things similar, and the reply that the concept is bounded by practice, not by definition.	Listing games.
Comment / Do you agree?	a defended ruling in line 1	Take a side on behaviourism, on Kripke's reading, or on quietism — and defend it.	Reporting the debate.

Graded Verdict Bank - Executable Closing Positions

Sub-topic	10-mark verdict	15-mark verdict	20-mark verdict
The break from the <i>Tractatus</i>	The later work is not a change of subject but the dismantling of two <i>Tractatus</i> presuppositions Wittgenstein was himself the first to identify.	...Colour exclusion pressured the independence of apparently elementary propositions; the demand for determinate sense was seen to be a requirement imposed by a <i>picture</i> , not discovered in language.	The continuity is the conception of philosophy: in 1921 it is an activity of elucidation ending in silence, in 1953 an activity of therapy ending in the ability to stop. What changes is the diagnosis of what misleads us — logical form in the early work, the surface grammar of ordinary language in the later. Read this way the two books are one project pursued with opposite assumptions about where sense comes from.
Meaning and use	Meaning is not a relation between word and object but a place in a practice ; asking for the meaning is asking for the technique of employment.	...This is not verificationism: use is not exhausted by checking-conditions, and imperatives, jokes, greetings and prayers all have use without truth-conditions. Verification-conditions are one restricted practice of assessment, not a universal special case licensed by §43.	The doctrine's strength is that it explains the phenomena the referential theory cannot — logical constants, sensation words, proper names of the non-existent. Its cost is normativity: if use fixes meaning, what distinguishes a mistake from a change? Wittgenstein's answer — that grammar and training set the standard — is adequate for stable practices and strained for creative and evolving ones, and this is the live tension in the doctrine.

Sub-topic	10-mark verdict	15-mark verdict	20-mark verdict
Language-games / forms of life	Language is not one thing with one essence but an indefinite family of practices woven into activities.	..."Forms of life" is where explanation stops — " this is simply what I do " (§217) — which is a limit, not an evasion, since any justification must terminate somewhere.	The concept of a form of life is the doctrine's greatest strength and its greatest obscurity: it grounds meaning in something more than convention (it is natural history, not agreement) while leaving unsettled whether forms of life are biological, cultural or both. The dispute between the "naturalist" and "culturalist" readings is unresolved, and any answer that names it is operating above the ordinary level.
Rule-following	The paradox is that no interpretation can fix a rule, since every interpretation itself needs interpreting; the regress ends in a practice , not in a further rule.	...§201's own resolution is that "there is a way of grasping a rule which is not an interpretation, but which is exhibited in what we call obeying the rule" — so the sceptical paradox is a <i>symptom</i> of the interpretation-model, not a conclusion.	Kripke's "sceptical solution" reads the argument as conceding that no fact constitutes meaning and replacing truth-conditions with community assertibility-conditions; Baker–Hacker and McDowell reply that Wittgenstein dissolves rather than concedes the paradox. The examiner-safe ruling: Kripke's reading is philosophically fertile and textually disputed — §201 explicitly names the paradox a <i>misunderstanding</i> , which is not how a sceptic writes.
Private language	A sign with no possible independent standard of correct application is not a sign; the private diarist only seems to mean something.	...The argument does not deny private <i>experience</i> , only private <i>meaning</i> ; and it works by removing the correct/seems-correct distinction, not by demanding public verification.	Its target is the whole Cartesian–empiricist architecture: if sensation-words cannot be privately grounded, then neither the cogito's inner theatre nor the sense-datum base can be the foundation of knowledge. Its cost is that it purchases this result with a strong premise — that correctness cannot collapse into present seeming — which Ayer's Crusoe case tests and which no formulation has made uncontroversially compelling.

Sub-topic	10-mark verdict	15-mark verdict	20-mark verdict
Criteria vs symptoms	Criteria are grammatical and defeasible; symptoms are inductive. That single distinction blocks the behaviourist reading.	...It allows Wittgenstein to say that behaviour is constitutive of the <i>concept</i> of pain without being identical to pain, and to preserve the first/third-person asymmetry the behaviourist must deny.	The distinction is what makes the philosophy of mind here genuinely third-way: anti-Cartesian without reduction. Its instability is that Wittgenstein himself notes the grammar <i>fluctuates</i> between criterion and symptom (§354), so the distinction cannot be drawn once and for all — which is either a candid recognition of how concepts work or an admission that the key notion is not sharp. Say which you think, and why.
Therapy / fly-bottle	Philosophical problems are disorientation, not ignorance; the trap is sustained by the thinker's route, and the remedy is a change of method, not a new theory.	...This is why "philosophy leaves everything as it is" and why no theses are advanced; success is measured by the ability to stop.	The quietist charge is the one to engage. It cannot be dismissed, because Wittgenstein does deliberately and severely narrow what philosophy may do. The defence worth making is that the narrowing is <i>local</i> : it forbids explanatory theory in the philosophy of language and mind, where the confusions are grammatical, and says nothing about ethics or politics. Whether that restriction can be principled, rather than merely announced, is the standing question.
Aspect-seeing	"I see that it has not changed; and yet I see it differently" — seeing-as is neither bare perception nor inference, and it presupposes mastery of a technique.	...It pressures a conceptually innocent Given: what one can see depends on what one can do with concepts.	Aspect-seeing provides an illuminating analogy for Wittgenstein's method. Therapy adds no facts and changes no object; it makes a new aspect of the familiar language-game dawn. That the doctrine of aspects and the conception of philosophy are the same thought is one possible line of support for unity in the later work and not, as Russell alleged, a collection of aphorisms.

Translation, Numbering and Provenance Discipline

Wittgenstein wrote in German; the *Investigations* is a posthumous compilation. Both facts constrain what you may assert.

Item	Status	Practice
<i>Philosophische Untersuchungen / Philosophical Investigations</i>	Written 1929–49; published posthumously in 1953 , edited by Anscombe and Rhees ; German–English facing pages	⚠️ Never write "Wittgenstein published the <i>Investigations</i> ." He did not publish it, and the arrangement of remarks is partly editorial.
Translations	Anscombe (1953); revised by Hacker and Schulte (4th edn, 2009)	⚠️ The 4th edition changes wording in places and — crucially — renames Part II as "Philosophy of Psychology — A Fragment," renumbering its sections . So "PI Part II §xi" (older editions) = "PPF §§111ff" (4th edn). If you cite the duck-rabbit, say "Part II §xi / PPF" rather than a bare number.
Citation by § number ✓	Part I remarks are numbered §1–§693 and the numbering is identical across editions and translations	Use § numbers rather than page numbers: §1 (Augustine), §7/§23 (language-games), §38 (language on holiday), §43 (meaning is use), §66–67 (family resemblance), §109 (description not explanation), §115 (a picture held us captive), §123, §124, §128, §133, §201 (the paradox), §217 (spade turned), §241–242 (agreement in form of life), §243–271 (private language), §244 (avowal), §255, §258 (diary), §293 (beetle), §304, §307–308 (behaviourism), §309 (fly-bottle), §354 (criteria/symptoms), §580 (outward criteria).
"Meaning is use"	⚠️ §43 is carefully hedged: "For a large class of cases — though not for all — in which we employ the word 'meaning' it can be defined thus: the meaning of a word is its use in the language."	✗ Never quote it without the qualification. Dropping "for a large class of cases" is the most frequent misquotation in the whole syllabus, and it converts a careful remark into the slogan Wittgenstein was avoiding.
"Language goes on holiday" (§38)	⚠️ The German is <i>wenn die Sprache feiert</i> — closer to "when language is idling " or "on vacation from work." Anscombe's "holiday" is idiomatic but slightly misleading; the image is machinery running without load, not a vacation.	Give the § and gloss the image, or paraphrase.
Fly-bottle (§309)	✓ "To show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle" is stable across editions	✓ Safe verbatim with §309.
Beetle in a box (§293)	✓	✓ Safe with §293.
Diary "S" (§258)	⚠️ Renderings of "whatever is going to seem right to me is right" vary slightly	Give §258; paraphrase rather than quote if unsure.
Blue and Brown Books	Dictated 1933–35 , published 1958	✓ The source for the criterion/symptom distinction and the angina example. ⚠️ They are <i>dictations to students</i> , not a work Wittgenstein prepared for print — say "in the <i>Blue Book</i> " rather than "Wittgenstein wrote."

Item	Status	Practice
On Certainty	Notes from 1949–51 , published 1969	✓ The source of the "hinge propositions" response to Moore. ⚠ Note it is Wittgenstein's last work and is unrevised.
Kripke's reading	<i>Wittgenstein on Rules and Private Language</i> , 1982	⚠ Kripke himself presents it as " Wittgenstein's argument as it struck Kripke ," not as exegesis. Say "Kripke's Wittgenstein" (the standard scholarly phrase, "Kripkenstein") and you signal awareness of the distinction.
"Forms of life" (<i>Lebensformen</i>)	Occurs only a handful of times in the <i>Investigations</i> (§19, §23, §241 and PPF)	⚠ Do not build a large doctrine on it and present that doctrine as Wittgenstein's stated theory; mark the interpretation as interpretation.
Duck-rabbit	The figure is Jastrow's (1899), reproduced by Wittgenstein	⚠ Do not attribute the drawing to Wittgenstein.

✗ **Never write:** that Wittgenstein "denied the existence of inner mental states" (§304 explicitly refuses this); that the private-language argument is directed at codes or at talking to oneself; or that "meaning is use" is offered as a general definition (§43 says otherwise).

Criticisms and Replies

Critic	Objection	Assessment
Ayer / Private-language defenders	A solitary person (Robinson Crusoe) <i>could</i> invent words for sensations — checking memory against itself is no worse than relying on the community.	⚠ Wittgenstein's defenders reply: even Crusoe uses <i>public-type</i> criteria (regular behaviour, physical correlates); the argument targets <i>logical</i> privacy (no possible check), not physical solitude.
Kripke ("Wittgenstein on Rules and Private Language")	Interprets the rule-following argument as yielding a <i>sceptical paradox</i> — no fact about me determines what I mean; the "solution" is merely communal agreement (a <i>sceptical solution</i>).	? Contested reading. Many scholars (Baker & Hacker, McDowell) deny Wittgenstein endorses scepticism about meaning; he dissolves the problem, not concedes it.
Functionalists / Cognitive scientists	Wittgenstein's focus on <i>public</i> criteria ignores the genuine causal role of inner states (brain states).	⚠ Wittgenstein does not <i>deny</i> inner states exist; he denies they can <i>ground</i> meaning independently of public criteria. Brain states and inner experiences are real but parasitic on public language for their <i>articulation</i> .
Is "meaning = use" too vague?	If meaning is use, how do we distinguish correct use from widespread misuse? Is there no norm beyond consensus?	⚠ Wittgenstein: grammar provides the norms; training into forms of life sets the standard. But this leaves open whether dead metaphors, poetic extensions, etc. are "uses" or "misuses" — a genuine tension.

Critic	Objection	Assessment
Conservatism charge	"Philosophy leaves everything as it is" — does this preclude philosophical progress or critique of social practices?	⚠ Wittgenstein's point is about <i>conceptual</i> description, not social conservatism. Therapy removes confusion; it does not forbid reform — but the scope of what philosophy <i>can</i> do is deliberately narrowed.

Common UPSC Traps

Trap	Discrimination
"Private language = a secret code"	No. A secret code is still a public language (decipherable). Private language means words whose meaning is constituted by <i>logically</i> private experience — <i>in principle</i> unteachable.
"Wittgenstein denies inner experience exists"	No. He denies inner experience can <i>ground meaning</i> . Pain is real; but "pain" gets its meaning from public use, not from private ostension of a sensation.
"Meaning = use" is a <i>theory</i> of meaning	No. Wittgenstein refuses theories. It is a therapeutic reminder to look at <i>how words are used</i> rather than seeking a hidden essence.
"Family resemblance proves definitions are impossible"	Not quite. It shows that <i>not all</i> concepts admit of necessary-and-sufficient-condition definitions. Some do ("triangle"); many important ones (game, language, number) do not.
"Later Wittgenstein = logical positivism"	No. He <i>rejects</i> verificationism; meaning is use, not verification-conditions. Metaphysics is "language on holiday," not "meaningless."
"The private-language argument refutes solipsism as false"	It does not prove it <i>false</i> (that would require a public-language argument for other minds). It shows solipsism is <i>inexpressible</i> / self-undermining — it cannot coherently be stated.
"Forms of life" = cultural relativism	❓ Contested. Wittgenstein's "forms of life" may be human-natural (shared biology, natural reactions) rather than culturally specific. He is not a cultural relativist in a straightforward sense.

Keyword and Statement Bank, Restored 2018/2020 Dossier and Corpus Delta

#	Item	Use
1	✅ "The meaning of a word is its use in the language." (§43)	Core thesis
2	✅ "To imagine a language means to imagine a form of life." (§19)	Forms of life
3	✅ "Philosophy is a battle against the bewitchment of our intelligence by means of language." (§109)	Therapeutic conception
4	✅ "Philosophy leaves everything as it is." (§124)	Non-revisionary therapy

#	Item	Use
5	✓ "If a lion could talk, we could not understand him."	Forms of life / incommensurability
6	✓ "Whatever seems right to me is right — and that only means that here we cannot talk about 'right'." (§258 substance)	Private-language argument
7	✓ "Don't think, but look!" (§66)	Family resemblance / method
8	⚠ Language-game (<i>Sprachspiel</i>)	Language + the activity it is woven into
9	⚠ Beetle-in-a-box	The private object "drops out as irrelevant"
10	⚠ The rule-following paradox (§201): "no course of action could be determined by a rule, because every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule"	Sets up private-language argument

RESTORED 2018/2020 DOCTRINE DOSSIER

Family resemblance and the grammar of games

- ✓ Uses of "game" overlap through criss-crossing similarities without one essence common to all instances. This supports language-games because speaking is a plurality of rule-governed practices, not one representational calculus.
- ⚠ Open texture is not lawlessness: local criteria and practices still distinguish correct from incorrect moves.

The private-diary case

- ✓ A sign intended to name a recurring private sensation needs a criterion for using it correctly on later occasions. Private ostensive definition cannot supply one because whatever seems right would count as right.
- ✓ **Presupposition:** following a rule requires a normatively stable practice, not necessarily a large public audience but criteria not exhausted by present impression. - ? **Objection** → **reply:** first-person sensation reports appear privately authoritative. Wittgenstein does not deny sensations; he argues that the language used to report them derives its grammar from shared practices.

CORPUS-DRIVEN DEPTH DELTA (complete 2018–2025 audit)

- ⚠ **Priority:** Primary ownership is 7 of 112 parts; 2021 remains the only year without an owned part. - ✓ **Required doctrinal depth:** The restored years add family resemblance as the grammar of "game" and the private-diary formulation of the private-language problem. - ✗ **Trap / answer consequence:** Do not say family resemblance means absence of all order, or that privacy is impossible; the target is a putative rule whose correctness cannot be distinguished from seeming correct.

PYQ Routing (2018-2025)

 **Corpus signal:** 7 primary-owned question-parts out of 112. The local Paper I corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025. Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2018	Q1(c)	10 marks	How does the notion of 'family resemblance' help Wittgenstein to uphold that 'Language is a game'? Discuss.
2019	Q3(b)	15 marks	Show how Wittgenstein's critique of solipsism culminates in the critique of private language.
2020	Q4(c)	15 marks	"But could we also imagine a language in which a person could write down or give vocal expression to his inner experiences—his feelings, moods and the rest—for his private use?" Critically discuss the answer offered by Wittgenstein to this question.
2022	Q1(c)	10 marks	Establish the tenability of later Wittgenstein's notion of language as form of life.  The official English line itself prints " motion "; it is retained rather than silently changed to "notion".
2023	Q4(c)	15 marks	What were the main reasons that led Wittgenstein to shift from picture-theory of meaning to use-theory of meaning? Critically discuss.
2024	Q1(d)	10 marks	Why does later Wittgenstein think that there cannot be a language that only one person can speak — a language that is essentially private? Discuss.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2025	Q3(a)	20 marks	"We should look not to an ideal language which derives its meaning from facts and has a precise 'logical structure' but empirically, to the ways in which languages are actually used." Explain the transition from early views of Wittgenstein to his later views on language and meaning with reference to this statement. ? The unmatched opening quotation before logical structure is visible in the official English line and is retained.

See the Western Philosophy PYQ Bank, 2018–2025.

Answer Architecture (10 / 15 / 20 Marks)

10-mark: "Why does later Wittgenstein think there cannot be an essentially private language?" (2024)

Define : Private language = words getting meaning from logically private sensations,
in principle unteachable. (NOT a secret code.)
Argument: (i) Meaningful sign needs a rule with a criterion of correct application.
(ii) Private "rule" has NO independent criterion – whatever seems right IS right.
(iii) Therefore no rule, no meaning → private language is impossible.
Illustr : Beetle-in-a-box: the private object "drops out as irrelevant."
Result : Private ostension cannot alone fix correctness; solitary public-type techniques remain possible.

15-mark: "Show how critique of solipsism culminates in critique of private language." (2019)

Frame : Solipsism = "only my experiences are real." To state this, solipsist needs
a language referring to HIS private experiences (private language).
Step 1 : Wittgenstein shows private language is impossible – the "S" diary argument:
no independent criterion → no rule → no meaning.
Step 2 : Beetle-in-a-box: private object irrelevant to public meaning.
Step 3 : If private language is impossible, solipsism cannot be coherently STATED –
its concepts cannot be grounded solely in logically private ostension.

Assess : The critique of solipsism is not a refutation (proving others exist) but a
 dissolution – showing solipsism is self-undermining. The private-language
 argument provides the decisive ground: language = public practice.
Close : Solipsistic private grounding is grammatically undermined; this is not
an empirical proof of other minds.

20-mark: "Explain the transition from early to later views on language and meaning." (2025)

Frame : The same philosopher – from the Tractatus (1921) to the Investigations (1953).
 The single most dramatic self-reversal in 20th-century philosophy.

Body-A : Early: picture theory – proposition = logical picture of a possible fact;
 shared logical form; one essence of language; ideal language behind ordinary;
 limits of language = limits of the world; silence on the unsayable.

Body-B : Reasons for break – colour-exclusion problem; failure to specify "objects";
 realisation that language serves indefinitely many purposes beyond stating facts;
 "Augustinian" picture of language covers only a tiny fragment.

Body-C : Later: meaning = USE; language-games (builders, ordering, praying, joking);
 family resemblance replaces single essence; forms of life as bedrock; rule-following grounded in practice, not interpretation.
 Consequence: philosophy = therapy (dissolve, don't construct); private ostension cannot alone fix a criterion of correctness.

Assess : The transition is from a *theoretical* to a *therapeutic* conception of philosophy.
 Early: one general architecture of factual sense. Later: resistance to one explanatory essence and grammatical description of diverse practices.

Strengths of the later view: liberates philosophy from the tyranny of the ideal-language model; accounts for richness of actual use. Critique: "use" may
 be too broad – when is use *correct*? Risk of quietism ("leaves everything as it is").

Close : The later Wittgenstein does not refute the early – he outgrows him, showing that
 the "crystalline purity" of logic was itself a dogma, not a discovery.

Link-Outs and Sources

- Moore-Russell-EarlyWittgenstein — the later work revises rather than simply repudiates the early programme: picture theory and a single logical architecture lose their governing role, while continuities in philosophical clarification and limits remain.
- Logical Positivism — the Vienna Circle was strongly influenced by and selectively appropriated the *Tractatus*, but the book was not their manifesto. Later Wittgenstein diverges from verificationist doctrine without thereby erasing every continuity of concern or method.
- Quine-Strawson — Quine's holism as a parallel dissolution of the analytic/synthetic basis of positivism; Strawson's descriptive metaphysics as conceptual analysis in a different key.
- Critiques of Metaphysics — Wittgenstein's therapeutic dissolution as the fourth assault on metaphysics (after Hume, Kant, Positivism).
- Self and Liberation — the private-language argument bears on the Buddhist *anātman* (no-self) thesis and the Western self/consciousness debate.
- Cross-paper: Religious Language — religion as a language-game / form of life (D.Z. Phillips, Wittgensteinian fideism); 2023 P-II Q5(d).
- PYQ bank: Western Philosophy PYQs, 2018–2025

SOURCES

- Ludwig Wittgenstein, *Philosophical Investigations* (1953) — the primary text (§§1–693). - Ludwig Wittgenstein, *The Blue and Brown Books* (1958) — transitional; early formulations of language-games and private-language ideas. - Saul Kripke, *Wittgenstein on Rules and Private Language* (1982) — influential (and contested) sceptical interpretation. - P.M.S. Hacker, *Wittgenstein: Meaning and Mind* (1990) — the orthodox (non-sceptical) reading. - Y. Masih, *A Critical History of Western Philosophy* (Wittgenstein chapter). - Anthony Kenny, *Wittgenstein* (Penguin, 1973) and *A New History of Western Philosophy*, vol. 4. - Nigel Warburton, *Philosophy: The Classics* (chapter on *Investigations*).

2026 OWNER ADDENDUM — WORDS, IDEAS AND THE MIND

Exact new demand

The 2026 paper asks whether words may be viewed as ideas in the speaker's mind. Later Wittgenstein rejects that general identification. A private image can accompany a word, but it does not establish the norm governing correct and incorrect applications. The same image may accompany different uses, different images may accompany the same use, and many expressions have no plausible mental object. Understanding is therefore displayed in mastery of a technique within a language-game rather than possession of an introspectible item.

WORD -> alleged private idea -> no independent standard of sameness or correctness
WORD -> trained use -> criteria, correction, continuation and shared intelligibility

This does not deny imagery, intention or inner experience. It denies that an idea in one mind is the semantic bearer that makes a word meaningful. The qualification matters: mental episodes may causally prompt or accompany speech, while grammar and public-type practice determine what counts as using the word correctly. This route connects PI 43, the rule-following discussion, the diary case and first-person avowals without reducing mind to behaviour.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH

— NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

ADVANCED SESSION 1 — The Break from the *Tractatus* - Placement, the One-Screen Map and Why the Later Philosophy Begins

The reasons for the shift - keep them ordered and named

Examiners in 2023 and 2025 ask *why* the shift happened. Give internal reasons, not biography:

- **The colour-exclusion problem (1929).** The *Tractatus* held elementary propositions to be logically independent, yet "a is red all over" excludes "a is green all over". Wittgenstein could not repair this within the old system; it was the first structural crack he himself noticed.
- **The Augustinian picture is too narrow.** Naming-an-object works for "table" but collapses for "the", "if", "five", "pain", "meaning", "perhaps". If one model cannot cover these, meaning cannot be exhausted by one naming model.
- **The demand for an ideal language is misdiagnosis.** Philosophical problems do not come from a defective surface language hiding a perfect logical one; they come from *misunderstanding* the ordinary language we already have. So "ordinary language is in order as it is."
- **From theory to description.** The deepest reason is methodological: the later Wittgenstein refuses to offer a rival *theory* of meaning at all. "Don't think, but look" replaces "posit the hidden essence".

ANALYSIS: the strongest answers present the break as *self-criticism from inside*, not as a fashion. The colour-exclusion crack is the empirical wedge; the Augustinian critique is the semantic wedge; the "ordinary language is in order" thesis is the methodological pay-off. State all three and you have the body of the 2023 answer already.

Provenance caution (worth a mark): the *Investigations* was published *posthumously in 1953* (Wittgenstein died 1951), edited by G. E. M. Anscombe and Rush Rhees, Anscombe translating. Never write "Wittgenstein published the *Investigations*". The *Tractatus* is 1921 (German) / 1922 (English).

ADVANCED SESSION 2 — Meaning as Use - the Toolbox, the PI 43 Qualification and Mastery of a Technique

The three moves - and the one qualification you must quote

- **Move 1: reject the referential / Augustinian picture.** Not every word names an object. "The", "if", "five", "meaning", "perhaps" have no object; even "table" is understood by using it, not by an inner ceremony of reference. Words are "tools in a toolbox" with diverse functions. - **Move 2: understanding is mastery of a technique.** To understand a word is to be able to *go on* using it correctly - a public, demonstrable ability, not a private mental episode. This quietly pre-loads the private-language argument (subtopic 7): if understanding were a private inner state, no one could check it, and "correct use" would lose its meaning.
- **Move 3: meaning is context-dependent.** "Water!" shouted at a fire, asked at a table, or written on a chemistry board does different work. Meaning lives in the language-game, not in the word taken neat.

ANALYSIS: the single most examiner-pleasing sentence here is the PI 43 hedge - **"For a large class of cases - though not for all - in which we employ the word 'meaning' it can be defined thus: the meaning of a word is its use in the language."** Reproducing the qualification shows that Wittgenstein is *describing a large family of uses*, not legislating a new dogma "all meaning is use". Answers that flatten section 43 into "meaning IS use, full stop" mis-state the text and lose the mark.

Caution: "use theory" is a helpful label but Wittgenstein resists calling it a *theory* of meaning; it is a reminder of how the word "meaning" itself is used. Keep the anti-theory posture from subtopic 1 in view.

ADVANCED SESSION 3 — Family Resemblance - Overlapping Similarities, Fuzzy Boundaries and 'Don't Think, But Look'

Why this is a weapon, not a curiosity

- **It kills the Socratic/Tractarian demand for essences.** Since Plato, philosophy assumed a real definition (necessary and sufficient conditions) hides behind every general word. Family resemblance says: not always, and that is *fine* - "game", "language", "number", "understanding" work without one. This directly dissolves a whole genre of "what is X really?" questions.
- **Fuzzy boundaries are a feature.** A concept with blurred edges is not defective; "is a photograph a picture?" has no forced answer, and the language runs perfectly. Demanding sharpness everywhere is the mistake, not the blur. - **"Don't think, but look" is the method in miniature.** It tells you to *describe the variety* of uses rather than *posit* a hidden unity. This is the anti-essentialism that powers the treatment of "language" itself: there is no single essence of language, only many language-games (subtopic 4).

ANALYSIS: the 2018 question ties family resemblance to "language is a game". The link is exact: because "game" has no essence, the analogy "language is a game" does not smuggle in a hidden essence of language either - it *frees* us from the search for one. Family resemblance is thus not a side-

topic but the logical bridge from "meaning as use" to "language-games".

Caution: family resemblance is *not* the claim that games share a vague "something"; it is the stronger claim that there is *no single feature* common to all - only overlapping likenesses. Writing "they all share family resemblance" as if that were the common property inverts the point.

ADVANCED SESSION 4 — Language-Games - Language Woven into Activity, the Builders and Rules by Training

The load-bearing claims

- **Definition matters.** A language-game is not a metaphor for "conversation". It is the technical unit of the later philosophy: the *whole* of language-and-activity. Meaning is what a word does *inside* such a whole.
- **The builders show completeness.** The "Slab!/Block!/Pillar!" language is not a defective fragment of English; it is a self-contained language for its purpose. This detonates the *Tractatus* assumption that all meaningful language must share one logical form. If a four-word practice is already a complete language, there is no universal form that meaning must take.
- **Rules are grounded in training, not Platonism.** We are drilled into the games as children; correctness is a matter of shared practice, not of matching a hidden calculus. This sets up rule-following (subtopic 6): the "rules" of a game cannot be a further set of rules all the way down - at some point there is just what we are trained to do. - **Plurality and change.** There is no fixed list of games; they arise and lapse. Language is "living".

ANALYSIS: keep the entailment chain visible - **many games -> no single essence of language (family resemblance) -> rules rest on training/practice -> practice rests on forms of life (subtopic 5)**. Each link is a separate exam prompt, but the strongest answers show them as one descent from surface variety to bedrock practice.

Caution: do not confuse a language-game with a "game" in the ordinary sense; the point of the word is the *rule-governed, trained, purposive* character shared with games, not amusement.

ADVANCED SESSION 5 — Forms of Life - PI 19, Agreement in Form of Life, the Lion Remark and the Bedrock of Justification

The claims that carry the marks

- **PI 19: "To imagine a language means to imagine a form of life."** A language is not free-floating; it is inseparable from a mode of living. This is the exact sentence the 2022 question is built on. - **Agreement in form of life, not in opinion.** Wittgenstein: humans "agree in the language they use... this is agreement not in opinions but in form of life." This blocks a relativist misreading (it is not "we just happen to vote the same") and an intellectualist one (it is not "we all believe the same theory"). It is shared *doing*.

- **The lion remark.** "If a lion could talk, we could not understand him" - because his form of life (reactions, activities, natural history) is so different that the words would not link to anything we share. Meaning presupposes a shared background, not just a shared vocabulary. - **Justification ends in practice.** "This is simply what I do" - there is no further ground beneath shared practice. This is the terminus of the rule-following considerations (subtopic 6) and the ground of the anti-private-language argument (subtopic 7).

ANALYSIS: "form of life" is Wittgenstein's anti-foundationalist bedrock, and it is easy to over-read. It does *not* license cultural relativism ("anything goes if your culture does it"), because the shared background is largely *natural* (common reactions, the human body, primitive responses), not merely conventional. The exam-safe formulation: forms of life are the *given* - "what has to be accepted, the given, is - so one could say - forms of life."

Caution: the term appears rarely in the text but bears huge weight; do not inflate it into a full social theory. Keep it as the *bedrock where explanation stops*.

ADVANCED SESSION 6 — Rule-Following and the Paradox (PI 201) - Interpretation Regress, Practice and Going On

The argument, and why it matters downstream

- **The problem (PI 201).** "This was our paradox: no course of action could be determined by a rule, because every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule." If *any* action can be squared with the rule under some interpretation, then "according with the rule" determines nothing.
- **The resolution.** The paradox shows that grasping a rule *cannot consist in interpreting it* - "there is a way of grasping a rule which is not an interpretation, but which is exhibited in what we call 'obeying the rule' and 'going against it' in actual cases." Rule-following is a **custom, a practice**, grounded in training and, ultimately, in a shared form of life (subtopic 5). - **Normativity survives.** This is not "anything goes": within the practice there is a genuine right and wrong. What is denied is that correctness is fixed by a *private mental interpretation*; it is fixed by public, trained practice.
- **The bridge to private language.** If following a rule requires a shared practice with public criteria for correct application, then a *purely private* rule - one that no one else could in principle check - is incoherent. This is the direct hinge into subtopic 7.

ANALYSIS: name, but keep separate, the famous secondary reading - **Kripke's Wittgenstein ("Kripkenstein")**, which recasts 201 as a *sceptical paradox* about meaning and offers a *community/"sceptical solution"* (correctness = accord with the community). It is a powerful, examinable interpretation, but it is a *reading of* Wittgenstein, not his own words; Baker and Hacker contest it. Present the text first, then flag Kripke's community objection and reply as a labelled interpretive dispute - do not present it as the canonical doctrine.

Caution: the resolution is not "there are no rules" and not "rules are whatever the individual feels"; it is "rules are sustained by shared practice." Misreading 201 as endorsing the paradox (rather than dissolving it) is the classic error.

ADVANCED SESSION 7 — The Private-Language Argument - Logical Privacy, the Diary 'S', the Beetle and Public Criteria

The argument in steps, plus the solipsism connection

- **Step 1 - the definition (do not skip).** Private language = signs for *logically private* sensations, unintelligible in principle to others. Rule out the impostors: codes (translatable), soliloquy (public language spoken quietly), contingently unshared jargon.
- **Step 2 - the need for a criterion of correctness.** From rule-following (subtopic 6): using a word correctly requires a standard independent of one's mere impression of correctness. Meaning needs the possibility of a *mistake*.
- **Step 3 - the diary (PI 258).** I define "S" by concentrating on a sensation and writing "S" when it recurs. But I have no independent check that today's "S" is the same as yesterday's; the only court of appeal is my present impression. "One would like to say: whatever is going to seem right to me is right. And that only means that here we can't talk about 'right'." Without a possible wrong, there is no right - so "S" names nothing; the sign is idling. - **Step 4 - the beetle (PI 293).** Suppose everyone has a "beetle" in a box only they can see. The public word "beetle" does its work regardless of the box's content, which might even be empty or constantly changing. "The thing in the box has no place in the language-game at all; not even as a *something*: for the box might even be empty." Meaning is carried by public use, not by a private inner object.
- **Step 5 - solipsism.** The private-language argument is Wittgenstein's dissolution of the solipsist/Cartesian starting point: the idea that each of us first knows only our own private inner world, and language names it inwardly. If that inner naming cannot even establish a rule for one word, the solipsist's "private world known only to me" cannot be a language at all - it is self-undermining. This is precisely the route the 2019 question demands ("critique of solipsism culminates in the critique of private language").

ANALYSIS: the argument does **not** deny that we have sensations, pains or an inner life (that misreading is the behaviourism charge, subtopic 8). It denies that a sensation can be a *private semantic foundation* - a meaning fixed by inner ostension alone. The move is from "meaning is private inner reference" to "meaning is public criterion-governed use." Keep the target precise and the beetle does the rest.

Caution: never paraphrase the beetle as "we can't know others' minds" - that is the very Cartesian scepticism Wittgenstein is dissolving, not endorsing. The beetle shows the private object is *irrelevant to meaning*, not "hidden behind a veil".

ADVANCED SESSION 8 — Criteria vs Symptoms, PI 580 Outward Criteria and the Behaviourism Charge Answered

The distinction, PI 580, and the behaviourism reply

- **Grammatical vs inductive.** A criterion is fixed by convention/grammar as (part of) what justifies applying the word; a symptom is fixed by experience as a correlate. Wittgenstein's own contrast: with angina, we may *define* the condition by one thing (say the bacillus - a criterion) while other

phenomena are *symptoms* we have found to accompany it; what is criterion and what is symptom can shift as knowledge changes. The point is that the criterial link to "pain" is *conceptual*, not merely evidential.

- **Defeasibility is the hinge.** Because criteria can be defeated (pretence, acting, suppression) without being falsified as criteria, Wittgenstein is *not* reducing pain to behaviour. A behaviourist reduction ("pain just *is* pain-behaviour") cannot allow pretence; Wittgenstein's criterial account positively *requires* that pain and pain-behaviour can come apart. That is the reply to the behaviourism charge in one stroke.
- **PI 580: "An 'inner process' stands in need of outward criteria."** This does not deny inner processes; it states their *grammar* - talk of the inner is anchored to public criteria, otherwise (per the private-language argument) it could not be meaningful talk at all.
- **First-person asymmetry / avowal.** I do not find out that I am in pain by observing my own wincing; "It hurts" is an *avowal* (Äusserung), a learned extension of natural pain-expression, not a report based on criteria. Criteria govern the *third-person* application ("he is in pain"); the first-person case is asymmetric. Preserving this asymmetry is what stops the account from collapsing into behaviourism from the other side.

ANALYSIS: the criterion/symptom distinction is the technical device that lets Wittgenstein occupy the *middle ground* - neither Cartesian inner-object semantics (refuted in subtopic 7) nor behaviourist reduction (refuted here). Examiners reward candidates who name this middle position explicitly: meaning is fixed by *defeasible public criteria*, while the inner life is neither denied nor made the semantic foundation.

Caution: do not say "criteria are just very reliable symptoms" - that collapses grammar into induction and hands the behaviourist the win. The difference is in *kind* (meaning-constituting vs experience-correlated), not in degree.

ADVANCED SESSION 9 — Philosophy as Therapy - Language on Holiday, the Fly-Bottle, Perspicuous Representation and 'Leaves Everything as It Is'

The method, stated as doctrine

- **Diagnosis: language idling.** "Philosophical problems arise when language goes on holiday." The confusion is not empirical ignorance but conceptual - a word cut from its use. Hence problems are to be *dissolved*, not answered.
- **The disease: bewitchment.** "Philosophy is a battle against the bewitchment of our intelligence by means of language." (PI 109) The philosopher's job is diagnostic. - **The positive tool: perspicuous representation (PI 122, authored above).** Therapy is not mere debunking; it assembles "reminders for a particular purpose" (PI 127) and arranges the grammar we already command into a surveyable whole so that we "see connexions". This is the constructive core people often miss when they caricature the later Wittgenstein as purely negative. - **The result: dissolution.** "What is your aim in philosophy? - To show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle." (PI 309) The problem does not get a theory; it stops seeming compulsory. - **The self-limit: quietism.** "Philosophy may in no way interfere with the actual use of language... It leaves everything as it is." (PI 124) "Philosophy simply puts everything before us, and neither explains nor deduces anything." (PI 126) There are no

philosophical theses, or if there were, everyone would agree to them (PI 128). - **Plurality of therapies.** "There is not a philosophical method, though there are indeed methods, like different therapies." (PI 133) The treatment is case-by-case, matched to the particular knot.

ANALYSIS: hold two things together or you will misrepresent him. (i) The method is *deflationary* - no theses, no explanations, leaves everything as it is. (ii) It is not *empty* - perspicuous representation is a real, positive achievement ("seeing connexions"), and "the real discovery is the one that gives philosophy peace" (PI 133). The exam-strong reading: later Wittgenstein replaces *theory-construction* with *therapeutic description*, whose success-condition is intellectual peace, not a new set of truths.

Provenance caution: these are numbered *Investigations* remarks (Part I), posthumous 1953.

"Perspicuous/surveyable representation" translates *übersichtliche Darstellung* (PI 122); flag the translation variance as you would for §43.

ADVANCED SESSION 10 — Aspect-Seeing and the Duck-Rabbit - Seeing-As, the Dawning of an Aspect and Aspect-Blindness

Why the duck-rabbit belongs in a meaning-and-use philosophy

- **Perception is technique-laden.** To see the figure *as* a rabbit you must already have mastered the concept "rabbit" and the technique of applying it. So even perceiving is continuous with the trained, rule-governed capacities that underlie meaning-as-use. Aspect-seeing thus generalises the book's central theme: *mastery of a technique* reaches all the way into how the world looks.
- **"Not part of perception" and "not an interpretation".** Wittgenstein places seeing-as in a peculiar category: "'Seeing as...' is not part of perception. And for that reason it is like seeing, and again not like seeing." It is *not* an inference we draw from neutral data ("these lines therefore a rabbit"); the aspect is *lived*, immediate, experiential. This blocks the intellectualist model on which we always perceive bare sense-data and then interpret.
- **Aspect-blindness as a diagnostic.** By imagining someone who could not see the switch, Wittgenstein isolates what aspect-perception adds - and connects it to *meaning-blindness*: someone deaf to the way a word can be experienced with a particular meaning ("say 'bank' and mean the river-side"). This ties aspect-seeing back to the experience of meaning.
- **Provenance note.** The material sits in *Investigations* Part II, section xi - in later scholarship (Hacker/Schulte) printed as **Philosophy of Psychology - A Fragment (PPF)** rather than "Part II". The figure is **Jastrow's** duck-rabbit, which Wittgenstein borrows. Cite it as PI Part II xi / PPF, not as a numbered Part I remark.

ANALYSIS: the philosophical payload is anti-empiricist about perception. If we always saw neutral data and *then* interpreted, aspect-seeing would just be re-interpreting - but Wittgenstein denies this: the aspect *dawns*, it is seen, not concluded. Perception already involves the conceptual mastery that his account of meaning made central. That is why the duck-rabbit is not a party trick appended to the book but a capstone showing the reach of "mastery of a technique".

Caution: do not equate seeing-as with interpretation or hypothesis; and do not treat aspect-blindness as a clinical claim - it is a *conceptual* device to show what aspect-perception contributes.

ADVANCED DOSSIER REFINEMENTS — USE SELECTIVELY

Classification: OPTIONAL ADVANCED. These interpretation debates are unnecessary for a competent Core answer and may be used only after the complete syllabus spine is secure.

- **Owner:** Later-Wittgenstein.md
- **Core prerequisite** ✅: finish the owner first for **Meaning and Use; Language-games; Critique of Private Language**; all routed 2018–2025 PYQs; break from the *Tractatus*; meaning-as-use; family resemblance; forms of life; the basic rule-following point; the diary argument and beetle-in-a-box.

Optional depth modules

1. **Kripkenstein and rule-following scepticism — second-order layer** ? - ✅ **Core status (15 Aug 2026 — partial promotion executed):** the rule-following paradox, the regress of interpretations and a one-line summary of Kripke's sceptical reading (with its 1982 source and the caution that Kripke presents it as "Wittgenstein's argument as it struck Kripke") **now live in Core** at Later-Wittgenstein.md. A candidate can therefore take a defended side on Kripke's reading without opening this file. - **Issue (second-order):** given Core's summary, is the "sceptical solution" a legitimate Wittgensteinian move at all, or a constructive theory Wittgenstein's method forbids? - **Competing interpretations:** Saul Kripke's sceptical reading with a community-based "solution"; anti-sceptical readings that treat Wittgenstein as dissolving, not endorsing, the paradox; practice-based but non-sceptical readings. - **Extra objection / counter-reply: Objection:** Kripke turns Wittgenstein into a theory-builder he would reject. **Counter-reply:** even critics admit the Kripkean sharpening is useful for seeing why private interpretation cannot fix normativity by itself. - **Safe 15/20 use** ⚠️: one short evaluative sentence in a rule-following/private-language answer is enough. - **What not to over-study** ⚠️: do not reconstruct the full "plus/quus" literature in exam conditions. - **Promotion status:** ✅ **fired for the paradox and the Kripke summary.** The plus/quus reconstruction and the sceptical-solution debate remain optional.
2. **Community requirement vs public criteria** ? - **Issue:** does Wittgenstein need an actual community for language, or only standards of correctness that are in principle shareable? - **Competing interpretations:** strong communitarian reading; public-criteria reading; solitary-but-trainable reading. - **Extra objection / counter-reply: Objection:** a solitary person can still follow rules. **Counter-reply:** Wittgenstein's real point is not headcount but the distinction between *seeming right* and *being right*, which requires standards not exhausted by a single moment's private impression. - **Safe 15/20 use** ⚠️: use only to refine the private-language critique; it should never replace the diary argument itself. - **What not to over-study** ⚠️: do not wander into sociological communitarianism far beyond the text. - **Promote to Core if:** a future PYQ explicitly asks whether Wittgenstein makes language essentially social.
3. **Therapy or positive theory?** ? - **Issue:** is "meaning is use" a substantive theory of meaning, or a therapeutic reminder against philosophical essentialism? - **Competing interpretations:** quietist/therapeutic reading; moderate positive-use theory; hybrid reading that treats §43 as a rule

of philosophical method, not a universal definition. - **Extra objection / counter-reply: Objection:** if Wittgenstein offers no theory, his slogans look empty. **Counter-reply:** his point is precisely that philosophical clarity often comes from reminding us of ordinary grammar rather than positing hidden mechanisms. - **Safe 15/20 use** ⚠️: works best as the final evaluative note in questions on transition from early to later Wittgenstein. - **What not to over-study** ⚠️: do not import the whole quietism debate into a basic language-games answer. - **Promote to Core if:** a future PYQ directly asks whether later Wittgenstein is therapeutic or theoretical.

- **Short source trail:** Wittgenstein *Philosophical Investigations*; Saul Kripke; Gordon Baker; P. M. S. Hacker; John McDowell; Marie McGinn; Stanley Cavell.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Placed last by design - after all teaching and all practice. Ten register blocks (one per subtopic), then provenance discipline and PYQ routing. Learn these cold; each block is a self-contained answer kernel.

RN-1 - The Break from the Tractatus

- Two Wittgensteins, one author: *Tractatus* (1921, picturing) vs *Investigations* (1953, use).
- Four flips: picturing -> **use**; single essence -> **family resemblance**; one general factual form -> **varied ordinary practices**; private reference -> private ostension cannot found a language. - Reasons for the shift: **colour-exclusion problem (1929)**; the **Augustinian** naming-picture is too narrow; philosophy needs **description, not theory** ("Don't think, but look"). - Ownership fact: **7** owned PYQ parts across 2018-2025; **2021** is the empty year.

RN-2 - Meaning as Use

- PI 43: "**the meaning of a word is its use in the language**" - quote the hedge, "**for a large class of cases - though not for all.**"
- Words are **tools in a toolbox** (diverse functions); "the", "if", "five", "pain" name no object. - **Understanding = mastery of a technique** = being able to "go on"; a public ability, not a private image. - Meaning is **context-dependent** (the language-game fixes it).

RN-3 - Family Resemblance

- Games share **no single common feature** - "a complicated network of similarities overlapping and criss-crossing"; model = a **family**. - Concepts may have **fuzzy boundaries** and still work; "**Don't think, but look!**"
- Bridge (2018): because "game" has no essence, "**language is a game**" smuggles in none - it dissolves the search.
- Trap: treating "family resemblance" as itself the shared property.

RN-4 - Language-Games

- **Sprachspiel** = language + the activities into which it is woven; **countless** games. - **Builders** ("Slab!"): a **complete primitive language**, proving meaning needs a role in a practice, not logical form. - **Rules by training** (drill, example, correction); language is **living** (games are born and die). - Chain: many games -> no essence -> rules by practice -> **forms of life**.

RN-5 - Forms of Life

- **PI 19**: "to imagine a language means to imagine a **form of life**" (Lebensform). - **Agreement in form of life, not in opinion** - shared *doing*; blocks relativist and intellectualist misreadings.
- **Lion remark**: too different a form of life -> no understanding even with speech. - **Bedrock**: "This is simply what I do"; forms of life are **"the given."**
- 2022 anomaly: printed **"motion"** for "notion" - retain and note.

RN-6 - Rule-Following (PI 201)

- **Paradox**: "no course of action could be determined by a rule, because every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule." - **Regress**: a rule to fix the rule needs its own rule - forever. - **Resolution**: grasping a rule is **"not an interpretation"** but is **exhibited in obeying** - a **practice/custom** grounded in training and form of life; normativity survives. - **Interpretive flag (keep labelled)**: **Kripkenstein** = sceptical paradox + community "solution"; a *reading*, contested by Baker/Hacker.
- Bridge: public criterion of correctness -> **no private rule** -> **no private language**.

RN-7 - The Private-Language Argument

- Target = **logically private** language (sensations unknowable to others in principle) - NOT a code, NOT soliloquy. - **Diary 258**: naming "S" has no independent check of "same" -> "whatever seems right is right... we can't talk about 'right'." No possible mistake -> no meaning. - **Beetle 293**: the private object "drops out as irrelevant"; "the box might even be empty." Meaning = **public use**. - **Solipsism (2019)**: its critique **culminates in** the critique of private language - the private world cannot even be said.
- Does NOT deny inner life or claim "we can't know other minds."

RN-8 - Criteria vs Symptoms; Behaviourism

- **Criterion** = **grammatical** (meaning-constituting, **defeasible**); **symptom** = **inductive** (experience-correlated). Difference in **kind**, not degree. - **PI 580**: "an 'inner process' stands in need of **outward criteria**" - grammar of inner talk, not its denial. - **Anti-behaviourism (PI 304, 307-308)**: rejects the inner *object* as semantic foundation ("grammatical fiction"), not the inner life - "not a something, but not a nothing either." Defeasibility (pretence) means pain != pain-behaviour.
- **First-person avowal**: "It hurts" is an expression, not a criterion-based report (asymmetry).

RN-9 - Philosophy as Therapy

- **Diagnosis:** problems arise when "**language goes on holiday**"; philosophy is "a battle against the **bewitchment** of our intelligence by means of language" (PI 109). - **Positive tool: perspicuous / surveyable representation** (PI 122, *übersichtliche Darstellung*) - "see connexions."
- **Aim:** "to show the fly the way out of the **fly-bottle**" (PI 309) - **dissolve**, not solve. - **Quietism:** "philosophy **leaves everything as it is**" (PI 124); no theses (PI 128); **different therapies**, not one method (PI 133).
- Objection/reply: "no theses" looks self-refuting -> reminders, not metaphysics; success = intellectual peace.

RN-10 - Aspect-Seeing / Duck-Rabbit

- **Duck-rabbit** (Jastrow; **PI Part II xi / PPF**): same marks, different **aspect**; the switch = **dawning of an aspect**; limit case = **aspect-blindness**. - Seeing-as is "**like seeing, and again not like seeing**" - **not** an interpretation/inference; it is experienced. - Payload: perception is **technique-laden** - the mastery behind meaning-as-use reaches into how we see (anti-empiricist about "bare data + interpretation"). - Provenance: cite **PPF / Part II xi**, credit **Jastrow**; not a numbered Part I remark.

RN-11 - Comparative Synthesis and Exact Distinctions

- **Early:** object/name, logical form, picture and ideal analysis; **Later:** practice, grammar, use, language-games, family resemblance and therapy.
- Preserve continuity in clarification and limits while stating the methodological discontinuity.
- Exact pairs: **criterion/evidence; symptom/criterion; private/secret; rule/regularity; use/intention; grammar/empirical fact; agreement/majority.**
- Contributions: ordinary-language philosophy, philosophy of mind, anti-essentialism and rule-following.
- Limits: quietism/conservatism, relativism worry, under-explained normativity, theoretical language and private experience.
- Qualified verdict: a powerful diagnostic method and critique of semantic foundations, not a complete general theory of meaning.

RN-P - Provenance and Translation Discipline (earns marks)

- *Investigations* = **posthumous, 1953**, ed. **G. E. M. Anscombe and Rush Rhees**, trans. **Anscombe** (Wittgenstein d. 1951). Never write "Wittgenstein published the Investigations."
- *Tractatus* = 1921 (German) / 1922 (English).
- Keep **PI 43** hedge verbatim: "for a large class of cases - though not for all."
- "Perspicuous / surveyable representation" translates *übersichtliche Darstellung* (PI 122) - flag the translation variance.
- Duck-rabbit sits in **PPF (Part II xi)**; do not cite it as a numbered Part I remark. - **Kripkenstein** is a *reading of* Wittgenstein (community/sceptical solution), not his own doctrine - keep labelled.

RN-R - PYQ Routing (exactly 7 owned parts, 2018-2025)

- **2018 Q1(c), 10:** family resemblance upholds "language is a game" -> RN-3 (+ RN-4). - **2019 Q3(b), 15:** solipsism culminates in the private-language critique -> RN-7 (+ RN-6, RN-8). - **2020 Q4(c), 15:** could there be a language for one's private use? Answer + critique -> RN-7 + RN-8. - **2022 Q1(c), 10:** language as **form of life** (printed "motion" = "notion") -> RN-5. - **2023 Q4(c), 15:** reasons for the shift picture -> use -> RN-1 + RN-2 (+ RN-9 close). - **2024 Q1(d), 10:** why no essentially private language -> RN-7 (tight). - **2025 Q3(a), 20:** the transition, via the quoted statement (unmatched quote before "logical structure") -> RN-1 + RN-2 (+ RN-9, RN-10 reach). - **2021:** no owned part - do not invent one.

REVIEW-PROMOTED LATER-WITTGENSTEIN CONTROLS

- §43 is qualified; use is norm-governed role, not frequency, utility or private choice.
- Ostension depends on samples, training and background language-games.
- Language-games are not arbitrary and forms of life do not entail simple relativism.
- Rule-following ends interpretation-regress in practice, not majority regularity.
- Private language denies private ostensive grounding, not sensations or solitary speakers.
- Beetle, criteria and avowals must not be converted into behaviourism.
- Therapy uses grammatical reminders/perspicuous representation and remains open to quietism critique.
- Colour exclusion pressures early atomism; it does not alone prove the entire later philosophy.
- On Certainty, aspect-seeing, religious language and broader ordinary-language philosophy stay bounded.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 1/10: Transition from picture and logical form to descriptive therapy

START -> Tractatus: proposition pictures a possible fact through shared logical form.

EARLY AIM -> philosophy clarifies limits of sense; factual saying differs from showing.

PRESSURE -> one essence, ideal analysis and independent elementary propositions fail.

LATER CONTEXT -> Philosophical Investigations, posthumous 1953; remarks, not a system.

SHIFT -> inspect diverse human practices instead of a hidden calculus beneath language.

CONTINUITY -> philosophical confusion and limits remain the governing concern.

DISCONTINUITY -> ideal logical analysis becomes description, reminders and therapy.

METHOD -> compare cases, display grammar, give a perspicuous representation.

TRAP -> do not import meaning-as-use into the Tractatus or erase all continuity.

ANSWER LINE -> one clarificatory project pursued through transformed assumptions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 2/10: Meaning and use beyond the Augustinian name-object model

PI 43 -> for a large class of cases, though not all, meaning is use in language.
AUGUSTINIAN PICTURE -> every word names an object; sentence combines names.
CORRECTION -> naming is one language-game, not the essence of all language.
USE -> norm-governed role in a practice, learned through training and contrast.
EXAMPLES -> slab, tools, colour terms, numbers, commands, jokes, prayers, avowals.
DISTINGUISH -> use != usage frequency != intention != reference != definition.
ANTI-BEHAVIOURISM -> public use does not reduce meaning to bodily movement.
OBJECTION -> circularity: meaningful use appears to presuppose meaning and norms.
REPLY -> grammar, correction and technique distinguish role from mere recurrence.
LIMIT -> practice displays normativity more clearly than it explains its authority.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 3/10: Ostensive definition, background grammar and family resemblance

POINTING -> red square may mean colour, shape, material, number, place or sample.
OSTENSIVE DEFINITION -> pointing works only within prior grammar and training.
COLOUR SAMPLE -> functions as a rule after comparison and application are learned.
NUMBER SERIES -> finite examples do not mechanically contain every future case.
FAMILY RESEMBLANCE -> similarities overlap and criss-cross without one common atom.
GAME -> board, card, ball, Olympic and solitary cases form an extensible network.
OPEN TEXTURE -> boundaries may remain flexible while standards still operate.
TRAP -> no single essence does not mean anything counts or definitions never work.
OBJECTION -> any two things resemble one another somehow; network seems permissive.
REPLY -> purposes, contrasts, training and judgments select relevant similarities.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 4/10: Language-games, grammar and organised human activity

LANGUAGE-GAME -> language intertwined with activity, training, rules and purpose.
COMPONENTS -> participants + circumstances + grammar + possible moves + responses.
SLAB GAME -> order, trained response and completed building action form one whole.
PLURALITY -> report, joke, pray, calculate, promise, ask, narrate and command.
ANALYSIS -> each game has a point and standards; the list alone proves nothing.
GRAMMAR -> norms of representation and use, not merely classroom syntax.
PUBLIC EXAMPLES -> railway request, court promise, market order, devotional prayer.
ERROR SOURCE -> expression is moved across games while its surface form is retained.
TRAP -> language-games are not literal contests or sealed cultural islands.
LIMIT -> strong at differentiation; thinner as causal theory of linguistic change.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 5/10: Forms of life, agreement in judgments and justificatory bedrock

FORM OF LIFE -> shared practices and natural reactions enabling intelligibility.
NOT -> biological determinism, total cultural worldview or sealed relativism.
LANGUAGE -> training and judgments rest on this enacted background.
AGREEMENT -> agreement in judgments and ways of acting, not every opinion.
MAJORITY -> numerical headcount is not the definition of correctness or truth.
BEDROCK -> reasons end in 'this is simply what I do' within an established practice.
LION -> radically different life can block understanding despite apparent speech.
STRENGTH -> avoids infinite explicit justification and private foundations.
OBJECTION -> social fact seems to replace reason; relativism or conservatism threatens.
LIMIT -> balance among natural, cultural and normative elements remains unsettled.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 6/10: Rule-following, finite instruction and the normativity problem

RULE-FOLLOWING -> being correct differs from merely recurring or seeming correct.
PARADOX PI 201 -> every finite course can be interpreted to fit divergent rules.
REGRESS -> another interpretation needs another rule; no interpretation is final.
TEXTUAL RESPONSE -> grasp of a rule is exhibited in obeying and violating it.
BRIDGE -> finite rule + training + examples + correction -> normative continuation.
REGULARITY != RULE -> only a rule has a role for mistake, correction and breach.
KRIPKENSTEIN 1982 -> sceptical paradox plus community assertibility solution.
CAUTION -> Kripke's reconstruction is contested and not simple textual identity.
INDIVIDUAL PRACTICE -> standards may persist without present majority headcount.
LIMIT -> practice may describe normativity without fully explaining its authority.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 7/10: Essentially private language and the diary S failure

TARGET -> signs for sensations knowable in principle only to one speaker.
PLUS -> correctness cannot be independently distinguished from present seeming.
NOT TARGET -> private thought, English diary, secret code or first-person authority.
PRIVATE OSTENSION -> inward attention is supposed to fix sign S.
DIARY -> later S is checked against an inner memory sample or table.
FAILURE -> the present impression judges both sample and application.
NORMATIVITY -> seeming right cannot constitute being right where no error is possible.
MEMORY REPLY -> perfect reliability still needs a standard of same/correct use.
PUBLIC-WORD REPLY -> importing public grammar abandons essential private

grounding.

LIMIT -> temporally extended individual-practice replies keep the debate open.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 8/10: Sensation grammar, avowals, criteria and the beetle illustration

CRITERION -> grammatical ground for application; defeasible, not infallible.

EVIDENCE/SYMPTOM -> empirical support or correlation; revisable by investigation.

AVOWAL -> 'I am in pain' expresses pain; it is not self-observation from behaviour.

THIRD PERSON -> 'She is in pain' uses context, expression and outward criteria.

BEETLE -> private object drops out of the public word's grammar.

CAUTION -> beetle is an illustration, not the whole private-language proof.

ANTI-BEHAVIOURISM -> criteria organise a concept but do not equal bodily motion.

SECRET CODE -> rule is teachable/checkable; concealment is merely contingent.

PUBLIC CRITERIA != majority vote, surveillance or conclusive behavioural symptom.

LIMIT -> grammar leaves the qualitative character of experience under-described.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 9/10: Perspicuous representation and philosophical therapy

DIAGNOSIS -> language idles or goes on holiday outside its home practice.

CAPTIVE PICTURE -> surface analogy makes a pseudo-demand seem unavoidable.

PROBLEM FORM -> philosophical disorientation: 'I do not know my way about.'

TOOLS -> description, reminders, comparisons and perspicuous representation.

PERSPICUOUS -> arrange grammar so connections and crossed games become visible.

THERAPY -> local treatments; no one empirical science or metaphysical system.

FLY-BOTTLE -> show the path out of a self-generated conceptual trap.

QUIETISM -> 'leaves everything as it is' can appear conservative or self-defeating.

REPLY -> first-order science, ethics and reform are not automatically prohibited.

LIMIT -> identifying every persistent problem as grammatical risks unfalsifiability.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 10/10: Early-later synthesis, distinctions and answer spine

EARLY -> name/object, logical form, picture, ideal analysis and saying/showing.

LATER -> practice, grammar, use, games, family resemblance and therapeutic dissolution.

CONTRIBUTION -> ordinary language, mind, anti-essentialism and rule-following.

LIMITS -> quietism, relativism, normativity, science and private experience.

DISTINGUISH -> criterion/evidence; symptom/criterion; private/secret.

DISTINGUISH -> rule/regularity; use/intention; grammar/empirical fact.

DISTINGUISH -> agreement in judgments/majority headcount.

ENRICHMENT -> aspect-seeing, certainty, religion and post-Wittgensteinian debate.

ANSWER SPINE -> thesis -> definitions -> mechanism -> objection/reply ->

comparison.

VERDICT -> powerful anti-essentialist method; incomplete general explanatory theory.